

Dossier for Tenure Review



Image: Columbia College, January 2020
Title: *A Spooky Welcome (and foggy)*



Image: Columbia College, October 2024
Title: *Resilient through the Storm*
Caption: Much has changed at CC (notice the missing branches) since 2020, but we are strong.

Dr. Jon Oxford

December 2024





SUMMARY OF ACTIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

for ☐ MID-PROBATIONARY REVIEW

for ☒ PROMOTION

for ☒ TENURE

Name of Candidate Dr. Jon Oxford

Date of Initial Full-Time Hire Aug. 2019 Rank at Time of Hire Assistant Professor

Current Rank and Title Assistant Professor of Psychology

Date of Current Rank Aug. 2019

Action is for: ☐ mid-probationary review ☐ tenure only
☒ tenure & promotion ☐ promotion only

Promotion is to (rank & title) Associate Professor of Psychology

Degree	Date	Institution	Area of study
Ph.D.	2010	University of Missouri, Columbia	Developmental Psychology
M.A.	2008	University of Missouri, Columbia	Developmental Psychology
B.A.	2004	University of Missouri, Columbia,	Biological Sciences

RECOMMENDATIONS

	Tenure	Promotion	Authorized Signature
Department	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Dean	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
TRAP	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Provost	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
President	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____
Acad. Affairs Cmte	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	_____

Date of Board Action: _____

TENURE: ☐ awarded effective _____ ☐ not awarded

PROMOTION: ☐ granted effective _____ ☐ not granted

SIGNATURE (certifying above as official college record):

Provost

Date

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Receiving the **Trustees Award for Teaching Excellence**, August 2024
Caption: *What? Me?*

Curriculum Vita

Jonathan Kendrick Oxford, Ph.D.

Email: Jkoxford@ccis.edu
Phone: (573) 864-9960
Address: 205 St. Clair Hall
Columbia College
Columbia, MO 65216

Education

- 2010 Ph.D. **Developmental Psychology**, University of Missouri, Columbia MO
Dissertation: Individual Differences Affect Hormonal Responses to a Team-based Violent Videogame Competition, but not in Solitary Play.
- 2008 M.A. **Developmental Psychology**, [University of Missouri](#), Columbia MO
Thesis: [Testosterone and Cortisol in Coalitional Competition.](#)
- 2004 B.A. **[Biological Sciences](#)**, University of Missouri, Columbia MO
Focus: Evolutionary Behavioral Ecology, Animal Communication

Professional Appointments

- 2019-Present Assistant Professor, Columbia College, Columbia MO
- 2015-19 Assistant Professor, Southern Arkansas University, Magnolia AR
- 2015 Adjunct Instructor, Stephens College, Columbia MO
- 2015 Adjunct Instructor, Columbia College, Columbia MO
- 2012-2014 [Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Alexander Von Humboldt Foundation](#), Germany
- 2011 Adjunct Instructor, Central Methodist University, Fayette MO
- 2010 Research Associate, University of Missouri, Columbia MO

Teaching Experience

Biopsychology Courses (cross listed with Biology)

Physiological Psychology	Neuroscience
Sensation & Perception	Animal Behavior
Evolutionary Biopsychology	Mind, Brain, and Behavior
Human Evolution	

Developmental Psychology Courses

Lifespan Development	Adolescent Psychology
Child Psychology	

Psychology Courses

Introductory Psychology	Online Introductory Psychology
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Abnormal Psychology
Integrative (Capstone)
Applied Psychology
Psychology of Emotion
Social Science Writing
Theories of Personality
Health Psychology
Statistics for Behavioral Sciences

Cognitive Psychology
Independent Research
Psychology Internship
Educational Psychology
Learning Theories
Human Sexuality
Social Science Writing

Publications

In Preparation:

Oxford, J., & Schultheiss, O. C. The effects of implicit motivations on hormone mediated learning in social victory and defeat.

Published:

Oxford, J., & Clayborn, A. (2023). Prolactin: Impacts of Fatherhood. In Shackelford, T. K. (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Oxford, J., & Oxford, D. N. (2022). Testosterone: Digit ratios. In Shackelford, T. K. (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Oxford, J., & Oxford, D. N. (2022). Testosterone: Paternal Investment. In Shackelford, T. K. (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Oxford, J., & Geary, D. (2019). Life History Evolution in Hominins. In *The Handbook of Cognitive Archaeology: Prehistory of Psychology*. Routledge.

Oxford, J., & Duncan, A. (2018). Sex Dimorphism. In V. Weekes-Shackelford, T. K. Shackelford, & V. A. Weekes-Shackelford (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Evolutionary Psychological Science*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Oxford, J. K., Tiedtke, J. M., Ossmann, A., Özbe, D., & Schultheiss, O. C. (2017). [Endocrine and aggressive responses to competition are moderated by contest outcome, gender, individual versus team competition, and implicit motives](#). *PLOS ONE*, 12(7), 1–32.

Oxford, J., & Oxford, D. N. (2016). Co-sleeping. In V. Weekes-Shackelford, T. K. Shackelford, & V. A. Weekes-Shackelford (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Evolutionary Psychological Science*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Bailey, D. H., Winegard, B., Oxford, J., & Geary, D. C. (2012). [Sex differences in in-group cooperation vary dynamically with competitive conditions and outcomes](#). *Evolutionary Psychology*, 10, 102–119.

Geary, D. C., Bailey, D. H., & Oxford, J. (2011). Reflections on the human family. In C. Salmon & T. Shackelford (Eds.), *The Oxford Handbook of Evolutionary Family Psychology* (pp. 365–385). New York: Oxford University Press.

Oxford, J., Ponzi, D., & Geary, D. C. (2010). [Hormonal responses differ when playing violent video games against an ingroup and outgroup](#). *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 31, 201-209.

Digested in [Science](#), 325, 1605.

Winegard, B., Bailey, D. H., Oxford, J., Geary, D. C. (2010). [Trade-offs and individual differences in evolved traits](#). *American Psychologist*, 65, 928-929.

Bailey, D. H., Oxford, J. K., & Geary, D. C. (2009). [Ultimate and proximate influences on human sex differences](#). *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 32, 266-267.

Fellowships, Awards

2024	TATE Award for Teaching Excellence	\$1000
2023	Deans Award for Scholarship	\$1000
2018	SAU Travel Grant	\$600
2018	Behavioral Social Sciences Travel	\$500
2018	Liberal and Performing Arts Travel	\$250
2018	Faculty Research Grant (SAU)	\$4000
2015	Behavioral Social Sciences Travel	\$400
2012-2014	Alexander von Humboldt Post-doctoral Fellowship	109, 200 EUR

Invited Presentations

Oxford, J., Tiedtke, J. M., Ossmann, A., Özbe, D., & Schultheiss, O. C. (2019). *Endocrine and aggressive responses to competition are moderated by contest outcome, gender, individual versus team competition, and implicit motives*. **Association for Psychological Science (APS)**, Washington D.C.

Presentations

Oxford, J. (2024). Teaching science writing with AI. **Society for the Teaching of Psychology**.

Oxford, J., Tiedtke, J. M., Ossmann, A., Özbe, D., & Schultheiss, O. C. (2018). *Associations between hormones, aggression, and implicit motives in response to virtual competitions*. **National Social Science Association**, New Orleans.

Schultheiss, O. C., Oxford, J. (2015). *The steroid-fueled motivational brain: Organizational and activational effects of hormones in implicit motivation*. **International Convention of Psychological Science**, Amsterdam.

Invited Speaking Events

University of Missouri – Columbia (2024). *Primate, and Hominin Evolution*. Evolutionary Ecology.

Columbia College Fall 2023. Co-presentation with Blake Nielsen. *Teaching and learning in AI world*.
Two Part Series.

Texas A&M University – Texarkana (2017). *Hormonal Responses to Virtual Competitions in Humans*

Southern Arkansas University (2016). *Understanding the Student Brain*. Presentation to faculty.

Friedrich-Alexander University (2014). *The Evolution and Expression of Sex Differences in Humans and Primates*. Lehrstuhl für Allgemeine Psychologie II.

Friedrich-Alexander University (2014). *Hormones and Implicit Motivations: Teams versus Individual Virtual Competitions*. Lehrstuhl für Allgemeine Psychologie II.

University of Missouri – Columbia. *Violent Videogame Play and the Proximate Expression of Human Intraspecific Competition*. Open presentation of Master's project.

Invited Colloquia

McGraw Hill – Nashville, TN

Collaborative think tank and venue for discussion of best practices, trends, and idea development for today's students

Affiliations

2021-present American Psychological Association (APA)

APA Division 2: Teaching of Psychology

APA Division 6: Society for Behavioral Neuroscience and Comparative Psychology

2019-present Association for Psychological Science (APS)

2010-2015 Evolution and Human Behavior Society

2015-2018 Southwest Psychological Association

2016-2017 National Social Science Association

PROFESSIONAL AND ACADEMIC SERVICE

Service to the Profession

Reviewer, *Journal of Research in Personality*

Reviewer, *Psychoneuroendocrinology*

Reviewer, *International Journal of Psychophysiology*

Reviewer, *Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada*

Reviewer, *Aggression and Violent Behavior*

Reviewer, *Sports Medicine*

External Tenure Review, Missouri State University

Service to Department/College

Columbia College

Committees

Chair Academic Honors and Awards 2023-2025

Member Academic Facilities, Resources, and Support 2022

Chair Instructional Facilities, Resources, and Support 2021-2022

Member Inclusive Pedagogy Committee 2022-current

Subcommittee Member Recruitment, Hiring, and Retention

Member Academic Honors and Awards 2022-2023

Member Psychology Faculty Search Committee 2022-2023

Member Psychology Remote Faculty Search Committee 2022-2023

Member High Flex Committee 2021-2022

Member HASS Curriculum and Academic Policies 2019-2020

Member Instructional Facilities, Resources, and Support 2021-2022

Member Elections and Professional Development 2021-2022

Course Design

Introduction to Psychology Online Development. Summer 2022.

Reviewer of Online Redevelopment

Psychological Disorders. Spring 2024.

Sensation & Perception. Fall 2021.

Lifespan Development. Fall 2021.

Southern Arkansas University

2017 - 2018 Statistical Consultation for Criminal Justice and Psychology Faculty

2017 - 2018 Peer-Review of Teaching Fellow Faculty

2017 - 2019 **Chair** Psychology Faculty Search Committee

2015 – 2018 **Member** Faculty Search Committees

2015 Psi Chi Sponsor for Speaking Events

2015 – 2019 Undergraduate Academic Advising

2017 **Member** Liberal and Performing Arts scholarship

2017-2019 **Chair** of Animal Subjects Committee

2017-2018 **Member** Emerson-Thomas Crone lecture series committee

2016-2017 **Member** Animal Subjects Committee

Community Service

2017-2019 **Board Member** Magnolia-Columbia County Literacy Council

Undergraduate Research Facilitated

2023 Acute stress and heart rate variability.

2019 The effect of sleep hygiene knowledge on academic performance.

2018 Examine Becks Anxiety Inventory as it relates social media usage and sleep loss, to be presented Southwestern Psychological Association.

2017 Undergraduate included in literature review on Sexual Dimorphism, resulting in publication.

2017 Five undergraduates included in research study on hormones, resulting in publication.

2016 Three students examined differences between traditional and non-traditional students on traits such as metacognition, cognitive strategy use and time management.

2016 Examined digit ratios and hormone relations within-existing post-doc dataset, introduced to multilevel models.

2016 Honors student examined migratory mechanism in monarch butterfly and lead class experiment on directionality during annual migration.

2016 Undergraduate included in literature review on Co-sleeping, resulting in publication.

Certificates

[Applying the Quality Matters Rubric](#)

Technical Skills

Hormone Analysis	Enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay (ELISA) Radioimmunoassay (RIA)
Statistical Modeling	R, SAS, SYSTAT, SPSS. Specialty, Multilevel Models.
Genetic Analysis	PCR, MU Medical School, Thyroiditis.
Advanced Programing	Medialab (Empirisoft) Inquisit, Direct RT (Millisecond Software)
Implicit Motive Coding	Picture Story Exercise (PSE)

Letter of Candidacy

To: Dr. Hamar, members of the Tenure, Review, and Promotion Committee, and colleagues of the Psychology, Sociology, and Human Services Department

Thank you for evaluating my Dossier for Tenure and Promotion.

I received my doctorate in Psychology from the University of Missouri in 2010, and shortly afterwards completed a two-year Alexander von Humboldt post-doctoral fellowship in Erlangen, Germany. Following which I was an assistant professor for four years at Southern Arkansas University. I began at Columbia College full-time in the Fall of 2019.

The following sections are organized to align with the criteria outlined in the Columbia College Faculty Handbook, addressing my contributions in teaching, professional development, and service since joining the institution. Each section begins with the guidelines from the handbook with a concise summary of key points, which are elaborated subsequently after the page break. To maintain a streamlined and organized presentation, I have incorporated links to relevant materials housed in my Google Drive. These links are secure and provide access to helpful media and supporting documentation.

Note on links: On Windows, PDFs open in Microsoft Edge by default. When clicking links in a PDF viewed in Edge, the browser follows the link in the same tab rather than opening it in a new window or tab. To open links in a new tab while leaving the original Tenure Dossier PDF open, middle-click the link (push the mouse wheel). Alternatively, right-click the link and select Open in a New Tab.

Thank you for your time and consideration,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Jon Oxford'.

Jonathan K. Oxford, Ph.D.
AKA Herr Prof. Dr. Awesome-Sauce
The Unicorn Prof

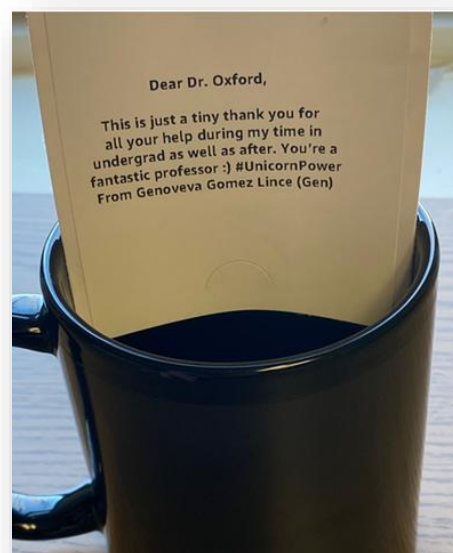
Teaching Growth

1.1.1 Baseline of Satisfactory Teaching Performance all faculty are expected to provide evidence of satisfactory teaching. Satisfactory teaching is evaluated across multiple instruments. A level of satisfactory teaching is established by the following:

- **A written narrative that reflects on the faculty member's teaching.**
 - The narrative should establish the faculty member's commitment to change and growth as a teacher through a discussion of areas in teaching that need improvement, but also document areas of teaching growth.
 - The narrative must reflect on standardized student evaluations of teaching.
 - The narrative must document how the instructor keeps course content and / or pedagogy current with the discipline.
 - The narrative must include reference to administrative teaching evaluations from the faculty member's chair and dean.
- **Faculty member should also include evidence of satisfactory teaching from at least three other means of evaluation, selected from the following:**
 - Peer evaluations of teaching
 - Examples of assignments and graded student work
 - Examples of instructor's other course material or class design (for example, but not limited to, syllabi, handouts, rubrics, or other pedagogical materials)
 - Other evidence

Here is a [link to a folder](#) containing all the files that support my teaching section. Each file is linked individually within the narrative below, but you may also browse them as a collective here if desired.

Link to less formal evidence of [student appreciation](#) that does not appear elsewhere.

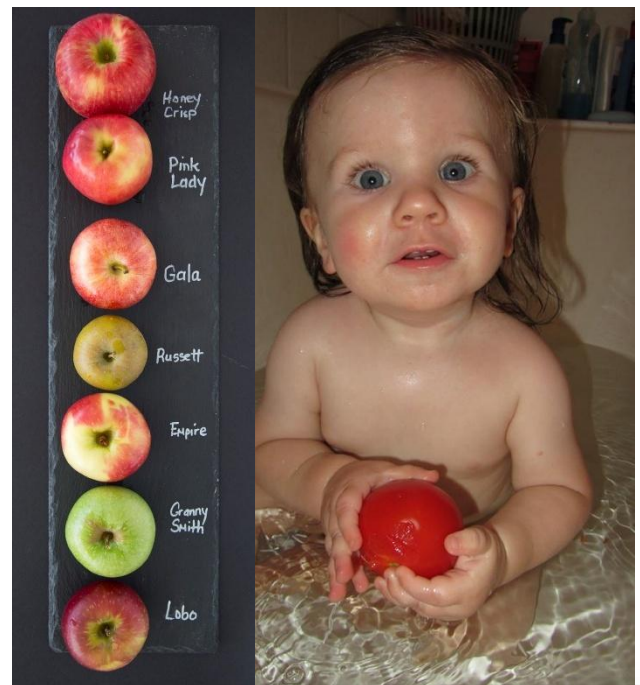


A Statement of My Philosophy of Teaching and Learning

I was not a normal child. My oddity had a couple of sources and may stem from being a child of the 80's. We did not have on demand entertainment, or the internet. On Saturdays, we had a few short hours of cartoons in the mornings, and an hour of Star Trek in the evenings. Otherwise, I had books and a prized Encyclopedia Britannica in particular. I loved the diversity of ideas I could explore with my encyclopedia. It is highly probable that I read the entire set, a feat that left me with many valuable things to say. My brothers teased me every time I interjected with some insight gained from my studies. I was a self-taught male version of Hermione Granger (the book-smart protagonist in the Harry Potter series). According to my grandfather, my self-teaching oddity was not inherent to me. He was a self-taught mechanic in the Korean war, after which he served as a drill sergeant in the Army for 20 years, which left him with a vast knowledge of how others tick. He told me that what makes us (Oxfords) different, is that we study things intensely, we have a passionate curiosity that leads us to master many things. In my years studying psychology, I have concluded that my approach to learning is not unique to just Oxfords, everyone does a deep dive when they are *interested* in what they are learning. Oxfords just apply interest more liberally. I see the same thing in my sons, the oldest is a self-taught wood worker, welder, and small engine mechanic, to name a few.

Everyone has an interest driven mode of learning that could be harnessed for every class, they just do not know yet that they are interested. I attempt to help them find that interest, by illuminating the links between what they know, their lives and cultures, and course material. When they know why it matters, it is more interesting. The problem with not knowing that they are interested is that students fall into a bad habit of learning only for assessments, and do not want to invest any more time or effort to fully grasp the concepts and linkages. In that way, they end up with individual units of a thing that quickly fade without the connections of a broader conceptual framework.

To stabilize the details, they need to be generalized into a *concept* or *essence*, like apple. When we recognize something as an apple, we are not just identifying its shape or color—we are activating a rich network of associated details and experiences. For instance, knowing that it is an apple brings to mind its taste (sweet or tart), its texture (crunchy or soft), its parts (like seeds, a stem, and a peel), and even how it is used (eaten raw, baked in a pie, or made into cider). This recognition connects sensory experiences, cultural knowledge, and personal memories, making the concept of "apple" much more than just a label. This richness stems from how our brains process and store information. Neuroscience shows that concepts like "apple" are not stored as isolated entities but as interconnected nodes in a vast network. When you think of an apple, related concepts—like its taste, smell, texture, and even symbolic meanings (e.g., health, knowledge, or temptation)—are activated in parallel. In the end, the concepts **predict** the



Guy Oxford is learning about essences. A tomato is not an Apple, despite some similar details.

pertinent details. Establishing those connections and meanings is not done with rote memorization, but rather elaboration – something I will discuss more later.

Geek thought to spark *your* interest: We do not all share the same concepts—take, for instance, whether a tennis ball is green or yellow. While our perceptions are similar enough for language to bridge the gap (i.e., within cultural contexts) and enable discussion, the subtle differences in our subjective experiences, or qualia, are what fuel our creativity, art, and passion, and ultimately define us as individuals. Teaching, at its core, is about embracing these differences while leveraging shared understanding to build a common reality where we can connect, communicate, and explore concepts *together*. It is not about a one-size-fits-all approach but rather about celebrating the unique ways students perceive and engage with the world while guiding them to find common ground.

In the age of AI, education should focus on these unique subjective experiences. Creativity—rooted in what we extract from our perceptions and experiences—will be essential for effectively using AI in the future. Teaching should embrace and nurture these differences, helping students develop the ability to think in ways that complement and enhance the capabilities of AI.

In Summary. Throughout my education, I discovered a deep fascination with the interconnectedness of knowledge, which shaped my identity as a passionate and curious learner. My acceptance to graduate programs in organic chemistry, biology, and psychology reflects my generalist mindset and belief that meaningful understanding arises not from isolated details but from the conceptual frameworks and connections between them. This perspective defines my teaching philosophy: to move beyond memorization and foster an environment where students uncover their personal connections to the material. By encouraging them to discern the broader frameworks in which concepts are nested and harness their unique interests, I aim to cultivate intellectual curiosity and deeper engagement. My teaching strategies emphasize **fairness**, **predictability**, and the creation of a **supportive** environment, inspiring students to explore and integrate knowledge meaningfully. Below, I will illustrate how I apply these principles to help students transform their learning experiences.

Some Examples of Creating Connections

As an example of creating connections and elaborating material in my classes, consider general psychology. Students are exposed to the first experimental psychologist named **Wilhelm Wundt**. Rather than memorize that he was the first, with a date, I propose that you read about him. If you do, you will discover that he provides links to other classes. For example, my whole course on Sensation-Perception (BIOL/PSYC 372), comes from his research, which was subverted by the Behaviorist movement, only to come back to the spotlight with modern psychology. Also, Wundt proposed the concept of the reflex arc (which we describe in BIOL/PSYC 371 Neuroscience) which was referenced by C. S. Sherrington in his Nobel Prize work describing properties of synapses which are the primary focus of my Neuroscience class. Moreover, you can feel the machines that he used, smell the dusty books, and discover a whole personal connection that cements the framework.

Similarly, I feel that a framework that includes psychology should be strongly scaffolded by neuroscience. With an understanding of how the biology of the brain works, you can reduce the size of the problem-space regarding possible psychological explanations. As an example, in teaching Theories of Learning (PSYC 410) there is a remarkable tedium in the number of details, and number of theories. However, since the time of those theories, the biology of learning has become remarkably clear with

modern neuroscience. Knowing the biology of learning allows us to frame material in terms of which parts work, and which do not. In that way we can harness a framework to predict the details and constrain the problem-space. With Animal Behavior (BIOL\PSYC 309) we can add the functional purpose of learning in animals, providing a useful contrast for understanding *why* we learn in the first place. We discover that unlike the behaviorist theories that we learn about in general psychology, the organism is not reactive as proposed, but predictive. Meaning that the organism develops expectations, rather than reacting to stimuli. This predictive mechanism is the basis of the modern understanding of why we have emotion, which both drives us and rewards us. Developing a cross discipline conceptual framework is the pinnacle of academics, and my goal as an educator.

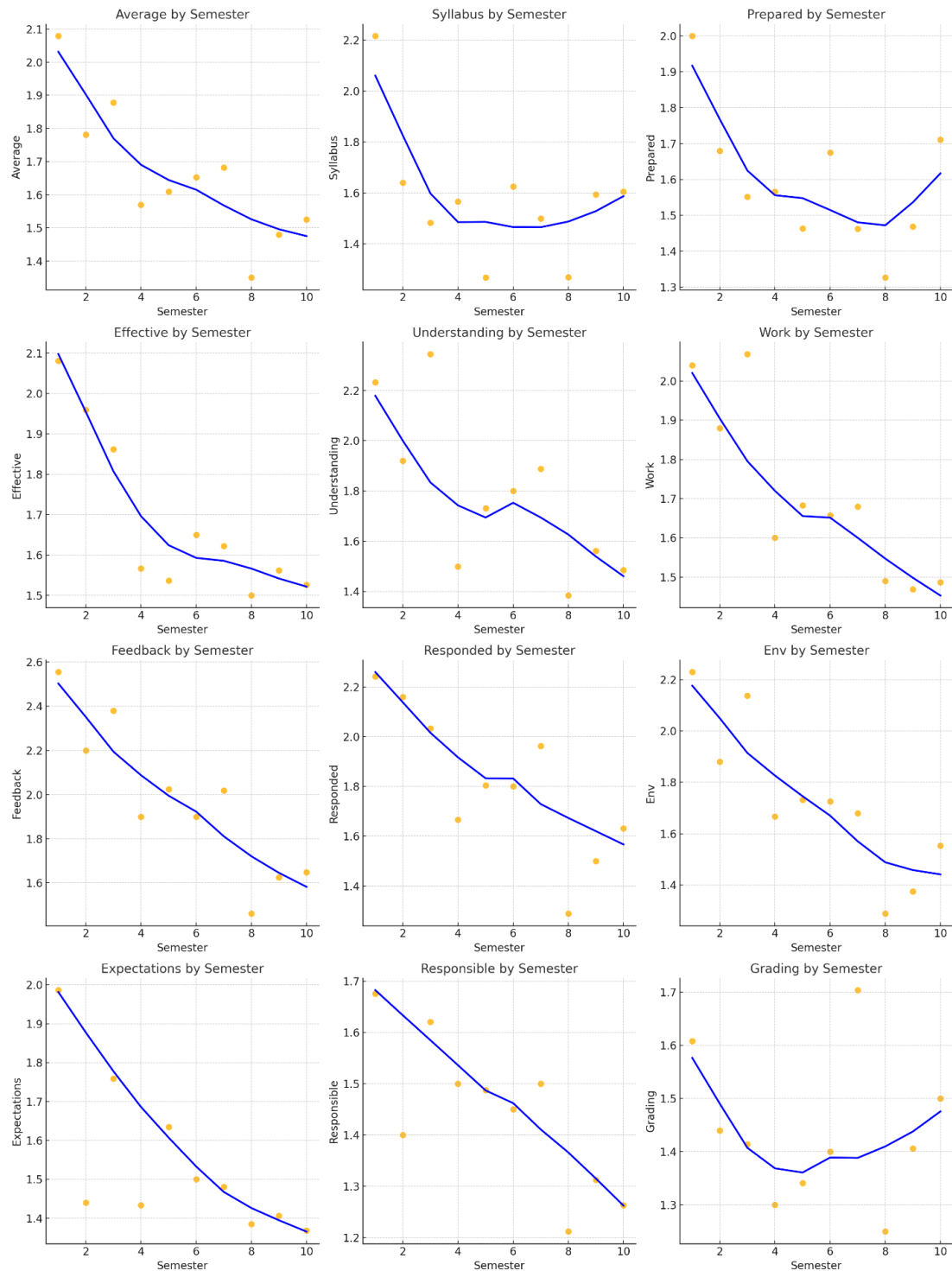
Support for utility of class material through integration

- *“Dr. Oxford is my favorite professor here at CC, I've had him in 3 courses now & in each one I have learned so much. I get to apply a lot of what I have learned from this specific class to my everyday life, and I often find myself using things I learned in class to teach friends about a particular subject.” SS21, Neuroscience*
- *“Animal behavior is a great class to be in. Instructor has a good sense of humor. He provided a very conducive environment for learning. I have to say after this class I see animal behavior differently and I am able to apply different learning skills.” SS21, Animal Behavior*
- *“Brought up many difficult ideas and questions that made the students consider abstract concepts or ideas.” FS20, General Psychology*
- *“Loved this class. He was very beneficial. Instead of just explaining what we needed to know for the test he gave us the overall picture which helped connect the dots.” SS20, General Psychology*
- *“The fact instructor excelled in teaching concepts without constantly going off of textbook definitions instead he applied concepts to real life experience that were more understandable.” FS21, General Psychology*
- *“This class taught me the most and was very helpful for many other classes as well we learned things that we will use for the rest of our career, it was a lot of work but his feedback and revisions were always helpful and prepared me for my degree.” FS23, Social Science Writing*

But, room for improvement after my first year.

- *“I hate to bring this up because I know this is just how his mind works, but Dr. Oxford skips around a lot. He makes a lot of connections across topics, which is fantastic! I'm so glad that he does. The problem is he doesn't always do a great job of conveying the connections he's seeing across topics. For those of us who are still learning the material that he has years of experience in, it often just looks like he's jumping topics. He could improve by showing us what he's seeing when he's connecting topics.” FS20, Mind, Brain, & Behavior*
 - This is an interesting comment from my third teaching semester. This course is all about big picture ideas and I quickly came to realize that it is possible for me to be overly excited and jump to the conclusion, before laying the foundation. I am very aware now and have been much more careful subsequently. Now, I teach it like a **suspense novel**, letting the excitement build and only revealing the magic when it is most powerful.

Reflecting on Standardized Student Evaluations



The array above shows trends in **standardized student evaluation** data plotted across all semesters. A Loess regression (blue line) was used to smooth the trend to make it more digestible. In these data, a trend downward indicates improvement (1 is the best, 5 needs improvement). The first panel is the Average across all scores and shows an overall trend of improvement. Each subsequent panel addresses one specific question (see key in the list below). Overall, these trends show significant improvements.

Student evaluation variables

- **Average** – average of all variables.
- **Syllabus** - course content matched the syllabus.
- **Prepared** - instructor was well prepared for class.
- **Effective** - instructor made effective use of class time.
- **Understanding** - increased my understanding of the subject.
- **Work** – assignments contributed to understanding.
- **Feedback** – provided helpful feedback.
- **Responded** – responded in a manner that furthered my learning.
- **Env** – created an environment conducive to learning.
- **Expectations** – set high expectations for me.
- **Responsible** – expected me to take responsibility for my part of the learning process.
- **Grading** – assignments were graded in a timely manner.

Student Evaluation Averages and Standard Deviations Rank Ordered by Mean

Rank	Variable	Mean	SD	Areas for Growth
1	Feedback	2	1.25	
2	Responded	1.83	1.16	
3	Understand	1.81	1.13	
4	Env	1.75	1.06	
5	Work	1.72	1.06	
6	Effective	1.7	0.97	
7	Syllabus	1.62	1	
8	Prepared	1.61	0.91	
9	Expectations	1.57	0.89	
10	Grading	1.46	0.82	
11	Responsible	1.46	0.78	Strengths

This chart presents overall (across all semesters) means for student evaluation categories ranging from 1 to 5 (1=best). Items are ranked in the first column to indicate areas needing growth with Rank 1 needing the most improvement, and Rank 11 the strongest evaluation variable. This table indicates that the following are the top 3 targets for growth:

Feedback – provided helpful feedback.

Responded – responded in a manner that furthered my learning.

Understanding – increased my understanding of the subject.

Break Down of First Two and Last Two Semesters

Indicators		First Two Semesters			Last Two Semesters		
Areas for Growth	Rank	Item	Mean	SD	Variable	Mean	SD
	1	Feedback	2.46	1.39	Feedback	1.64	1.15
	2	Responded	2.22	1.37	Syllabus	1.6	0.98
	3	Understanding	2.15	1.31	Prepared	1.6	0.98
	4	Env	2.14	1.23	Responded	1.57	1.07
	5	Syllabus	2.07	1.45	Effective	1.54	0.88
	6	Effective	2.05	1.18	Understanding	1.52	1.05
	7	Work	2	1.24	Work	1.48	0.93
	8	Prepared	1.92	1.15	Env	1.47	0.94
	9	Expectations	1.85	1.12	Grading	1.46	1.03
	10	Responsible	1.61	0.92	Expectations	1.39	0.8
	11	Grading	1.57	0.95	Responsible	1.29	0.73

Comparing my first two semesters (left) to my most recent two semesters (right). I conducted non-parametric tests to examine significant differences (not shown in the chart for simplicity), which revealed that all categories except **Grading** have significantly lower means in my last 2 semesters compared with my first 2 semesters, indicating improvement across the board. Grading is less interesting here, as it is among the strongest items in both categories already, and references only whether assignments were graded in a timely manner rather than the quality of grading.

Focusing on the Rank 1-5 (needing most improvement, above the **green line** in the middle) **Feedback**, **Responded**, and **Syllabus** appear in both first and last two semesters. Which makes them the highest priorities for improvement going forward. The challenges with Syllabus are understandable, given that 17 of my classes have involved new preparations, making perfect planning difficult. Additionally, my experimental teaching approach (i.e., described below) often requires flexibility, as strictly adhering to initial plans can hinder pedagogical innovation. I do feel that the Live Schedule mentioned below mitigates the discrepancy in expectations. This issue will self-correct to some degree as with more iterations of the classes, the more closely the syllabus will align planned course content.

Regarding **Feedback** and **Responded**, I recognize these as areas needing attention. I also found this in analyzing qualitative evaluation below. I am working to create assignments that facilitate more meaningful feedback and, as I teach courses iteratively, I am becoming more attuned to common student questions, enabling me to provide more targeted and effective responses. Furthermore, recent administrative evaluations indicate that students are indeed engaging with questions and receiving helpful feedback, reflecting progress in these areas. All in all, I believe the downward trend will continue, and I am attempting to improve these metrics.

Reflecting on Administrative Evaluations

Administrative evaluations provide a valuable lens for reflecting on and framing a narrative describing efforts to grow my teaching ([see them here](#)). Below is a chronological list of my administrative evaluations, with a summary of the list key points that illustrate a trajectory of successful growth. At the outset, I demonstrated strong organization, a clear understanding of the material, effective use of technology, and an energetic, enthusiastic teaching style. Progression in areas for improvement (**in red**) to areas of growth (**in green**) such as using student **names**, posing productive **questions**, creating an **environment** conducive to learning, incorporating **activities**, **discussions**, and **broad**er interactions.



2019 – Dr. Digernes reported that some questions appeared rhetorical making them unanswerable. No **activities**. Did not use **names**. There were no questions from the class. Though enthusiastic and fluid and organized.

2019 – Dr. Tabatabai said that I did have case studies, an **activity**. Classes still hesitant to speak, suggesting need for improved **environment**.

2021 – Dr. Mauxion suggested that I *should* elicit broader **participation** from class. Did not use student **names**. But good use of diverse modes for instruction.

2021 – Dr. Ford-Brown observing my fully virtual class during COVID was impressed with my use of a google doc outline with PPT that did elicit student attention and **participation** (i.e., **environment**). Though suggested that I should use more **names** and call on those not participating to keep everyone engaged. All in all, she was enthusiastic about the energy in a virtual classroom **environment**.

2022 – Dr. Mauxion commented that I *should* elicit active **participation**, suggested using more group activities. Still not using student **names**, but 6 of 13 students were actively participating.

2022 – Dr. Jewel proposed that I contextualize the material for students. We did have **discussions**. I had an open rapport with students and was supportive in answering **questions**. I was energetic and attempted to engage the broader class, using **names**. They were comfortable asking **questions**.

2023 – Dr. Mauxion reported that my class and I developed a productive class-long lecture-based **conversation**. In which students were comfortable asking questions (i.e., **environment**), and I was excited to answer them, leading to broader yet productive **conversations**. I did use student **names** and small group **activities** in which the course material was linked directly to their own lives and studies. Students eagerly **participated**.

2024 – Dr. Hendrickson said that I have a good rapport (i.e., **environment**) with students. Characterized the class as a **conversation** going from student experiences back to course material, and that I was able to direct that conversation back to the main topic of the day. In the end our conversation was focused, organized, and **productive**.

I believe Instructional Evaluations from my Deans and Chairs reflect substantial improvement in those metrics across my time at CC and suggest a transformation from being a somewhat detached lecturer to becoming a skilled conversationalist, effectively engaging students and fostering a more interactive and inclusive classroom environment. I also feel that that transformation is evidence of my sincere attention to feedback and passion for growth.

Reflecting on Annual Self-Evaluations

In the following section, I have crafted a narrative of my journey based on my self-evaluations. My narrative does not encompass every detail, but the full document can be found [here](#). The aim was to focus on a cohesive and meaningful account of my experiences and growth.

When I began my teaching career at Columbia College, I initially approached the role with a lecture-centered mindset. This approach was shaped by my own undergraduate experience at the University of Missouri, where large, impersonal classes and a lack of pedagogical innovation were commonplace. During graduate school, the focus on research rather than teaching left me with limited opportunities to design and implement my own courses.

My first teaching position in the United States (i.e., after Germany) involved classes of 50-80 students, where traditional lectures were the norm, and innovation in teaching methods was neither encouraged nor expected. However, from my first semester at Columbia College, it became clear that conventional lectures were no longer sufficient to engage students. The transition was made possible thanks to the invaluable support of Dr. Nielsen and Dr. Hendrickson. They provided resources, shared examples and insights, and acted as thoughtful mentors. Indeed, the faculty at Columbia College have been extraordinarily supportive, offering a collaborative environment unlike any I had experienced at other institutions.

Over time, my student evaluations began to reflect a shift in my teaching approach—from predominantly lecture-based to embracing a broader, more engaging array of methods. This evolution marks a source of pride, as it highlights my growing passion for teaching. However, the journey was not without its challenges. Early in my career, I struggled with **hesitation to experiment**. In my Midpro document, I described feeling a “**prohibitive inertia**” toward trying new strategies, fearing that students would quickly criticize changes or mistakes in their evaluations. As a meticulous planner with perfectionist tendencies, I was reluctant to risk missteps.

Despite these initial challenges, the past three years have been *transformative*. I have fully embraced an **experimental mindset** in my teaching, finding it both rewarding and invigorating. I now approach my courses as iterative projects, continuously trying new methods, assessing their effectiveness, and refining my strategies. This process aligns closely with my passion for optimization, as I find great satisfaction in tracking and measuring progress—both my students' and my own. To support this iterative approach, I maintain **detailed logs** for each course.

Early in my logs, I was curious about why classes differ. I was teaching two general psychology classes, and one was bubbly and fun, the other was quiet. Night and day difference, and I concluded that something happens at the beginning that sets a tone for the rest of the semester. I decided that I needed to use Icebreakers. Personally, I have never enjoyed icebreakers, but over time I realized their potential to not only facilitate interaction but also to support active learning, conceptual exploration, and community building.

My first attempt involved a speed-dating-style activity, where students rotated partners every 5 minutes until they had interacted with everyone in the class, including me. This approach not only broke the ice but also helped establish a sense of community early in the semester. In my Sensation and Perception class, I developed the "Sensory Superhero" activity. Students were tasked with creating a superhero and supervillain duo with opposing super-sensory abilities. This exercise required them to consider the capabilities, limitations, and interactions of different sensory modalities, effectively laying a foundation for concepts we explored later in the course. On the last day of class, we revisited this activity to reflect on how our understanding of sensory systems had evolved.

In my Statistics class this semester, I used a particularly interesting icebreaker. I taped a small slip of paper to each person's back with a printed prompt, such that they could not see their own. Prompts were something like "Hours slept last night" or "Your shoe size" ([see prompts here](#)). Students then circulated around the classroom introducing themselves, showing off their prompts, recording names and responses from all. Using their collected data, they attempted to deduce their assigned question, considering the range of the numbers, frequencies, and so on, just like we do with an experimental dataset. This activity not only facilitated getting to know their fellow classmates, but also introduced data collection and interpretation in a creative, social, and hands-on way.

This semester I attempted to keep the icebreaker going throughout the semester by assigning new partners for each chapter. They sat next to the new partner, worked on discussion questions, group quizzes, and during breaks chatted with them. When I asked everyone to review notes from last time and pose questions to the class, they answered with their partner. After quizzes, they conversed with them about what they missed first before asking others or me. I attempted this, because it appears to maintain an optimal level of stimulation, arousal, and curiosity across the semester. This ongoing interaction appeared to promote supportive interactions among many more students than a fixed seating chart. However, it was an experiment, and I will reassess based on any feedback received. From what I have gathered so far, they seem to think maintaining the same partner may be preferred, however it felt like it may have broadened their sense of class community and seemed to enhance participation in new ways.

One comment from administrative evaluations that occurred consistently was not **using student names**. My first approach was to have an alphabetical seating order to aid me in learning names quickly. This was actually a fun icebreaker because I put them in charge of communicating with their new classmates to figure where they needed to sit. Another method was attempting to take roster images from AVISO and arrange them like a seating chart. Then I noticed that Dr. Mauxion had taken a picture of his class, printed it and written the students' names in. That would work for me but does not incorporate enough convoluted use of technology. So, I began to take a picture of the class, paste it to a Google Slide, and have students create their own labels with preferred names, and pronouns when desired. I then post the link to my announcements section of the D2L homepage. For



the first portion of each class I have it open and displayed until class starts. Students look at it as they are arriving and getting settled, becoming familiar with others in their classroom too. Since implementing the google slide roster, I tend to have every student name memorized in the first couple of weeks and I use them, both out and about, and in the classroom. Students are impressed when I remember them by name years later.

While figuring out my experimental approach to teaching, and in responses to early evaluations, I needed a way to keep an up-to-date schedule/information source, so students **know my exact expectations**. I implemented a solution to enhance transparency and organization. I began embedding a dynamic Google Doc directly into the homepage of my D2L course site in the Announcements section (labeled as “**Live Schedule**”). This document is updated frequently, with a visible timestamp. It serves as the definitive source for all due dates and class activities. If there are any discrepancies between the schedule and dates in Dropbox, for example, then students know the Live Schedule is correct.

Beyond listing due dates, the Live Schedule includes a **detailed outline** of what we will cover in each class session, such as quizzes, discussions, or other activities. Additionally, when grading assignments, I provide **overall feedback** that I post directly in this document, attempting to improve the Feedback Metric from evaluations above. This allows us to **start each class** by reviewing the Live Schedule together, ensuring everyone is aligned and aware of expectations. This approach not only streamlines communication but also gives students confidence and clarity in navigating the course.

As described by Lisa Ford-Brown (Dean of HASS at the time) in the administrative evaluations, I also used google docs for **guided note-taking**, a document that was shared and editable for students. We would discuss course content for 10-15 minutes then take a minute to add some notes specific to our conversation and emphasize what is most important. That was useful during COVID-19 virtual learning, to co-create the take-home message and break up the class session. After COVID, this method was less effective and is used more for difficult topics.

Announcements ▾

Live Schedule and Comments ▾

Posted Dec 25, 2023 10:53 AM

Live Schedule and Comments Neuroscience - Updated 4-23

A note on due dates. 📅 [Link to class Roster](#)

Upcoming Dates

- M 1-29: Finish 1.2 (start slide 46), begin 2.1.
 - Discuss DB replies, Dropboxes.
- W 1-31: 2.1 (slide 15)
 - Quiz 1.2.
 - **Due:** Outline 2.2 to discussion board and to dropbox (Turnit-in)
- M 2-5: 2.2 in class (slide 22 of 49)
 - **Due:** Practice Quiz 2 by class time.
- W 2-7: Finish 2.2 in class.
 - Exam 1 in class.
- F 2-9: In class
 - Paper Presentations [use this link to add slides](#). Also submit to the Drop box for grading.
 - Quiz 2 in class.
 - W 28
 - Chapter 3

Live Schedule ▾

Posted Aug 15, 2024 9:06 AM

Some notes from Outline 8 - [See an Example Here](#)

- Needed types of long-term memory to help disambiguate them
- Amount and time of STM
- Don't list definitions only, digest the meaning of concepts
- Some didn't use the template, which is fine this time, but do in the future
- Structure helps with subheadings, fonts, formatting, color.

Week 5.

- Tues. 9-24. Chapter 6
 - **Due.** 6 Chapter Practice Quiz.
 - Post Chapter 6 outlines the Discussion Board. Some of us could benefit from examples of how others are doing the

Support for Google doc

"The class was good, and the guided notes helped better the understanding of the material."
SS20 General

In my exploration of evidence-based teaching strategies, I became intrigued by the concept of **peer instruction**, which suggests that novice learners benefit more from the insights of their peers than those of experts. Inspired by this, I developed an initiative called "**Eureka Moments**." Students experiencing moments of sudden insight or understanding share their discoveries on a discussion board and informally present them to the class. This approach recognizes that novice learning involves building concepts and connections shaped by individual experiences unique to their cohort. By sharing these "Eureka Moments," students can spark similar connections and insights in their peers, facilitating deeper learning. I presented this initiative at the FS22 Fall Faculty Conference ([Slide Show](#)), and it was adopted by Dr. Debord. See some examples of student Eureka Moments [here](#).

To further explore peer instruction in my PSYC 410 Theories of Learning course, I implemented a **collaborative approach** to the final exam. My goal was to encourage students to work together elaborating on key topics. I created a PowerPoint template ([see here](#)) with prompts in the form of images, videos, and questions. Each group collaboratively answered the questions and prepared to present their findings to the other groups. This process allowed students to see multiple perspectives and approaches to formulating correct responses. The final exam itself focused on the core of these questions, ensuring that students had ample opportunity to practice and elaborate on the material. This experience, like the Eureka Moments initiative, reinforced my belief in the power of peer learning and its potential to enhance understanding and engagement.

Recognizing the impact of peer learning from my earlier exploration of Learning Theories, I recently implemented a **peer-sharing** approach in my General Psychology course. I now have students post their completed assignments to a discussion board and encourage them to provide feedback to classmates, specifically targeting peers who took a **different yet effective approach**. This strategy has proven especially beneficial for assignments such as outlining textbook chapters. In the past, it was challenging to communicate expectations for outlining, even with examples provided. However, by allowing students to see a range of peers' outlines, they quickly discover diverse strategies and often exceed expectations, leading to significant improvements in the quality of their work. By purposefully viewing peer's work to improve their own, they are **actively discovering and diversifying** their own tool kit for approaching academic tasks. All in all, peer sharing has accelerated their rate of improvement.

Building on my earlier efforts to promote peer instruction, I have structured my courses so that every assessment is followed by an opportunity for students to engage in **peer discussions** about what they missed before we review the content as a class. This approach is especially effective for quizzes and exams, where students have the chance to become "peer teachers." By explaining concepts to their classmates, they not only reinforce their own understanding but also help others grasp what they might have struggled with. For my Tuesday-Thursday classes, I often incorporate brief group quizzes midway through the session. During these group quizzes, students are required to discuss each question before providing their answer. Then they discuss with neighboring groups anything that they missed. This collaborative approach serves multiple purposes: it encourages active engagement, reinforces key points from the lecture, and sets the stage for upcoming topics. The discussions also help students process what they have just learned in real-time, solidifying their comprehension and preparing them

2022 Fall Faculty Conference

Breakout Session B: Community Building & Eureka Moments

Center for Teaching and Learning



Dr. Sandy Hamar
Associate Professor of Education



Dr. Jon Oxford
Assistant Professor of Psychology



Dr. Ilcidi Monroe
Assistant Professor of Nursing

Room: DOR 107

Join us to discuss techniques to start relationship building immediately, connecting with your students, and using 'eureka moments' for peer-to-peer sharing. This session highlights some quick methods for building community, getting to know your students, and setting them (and yourself) up for success. We'll share how connections are a crucial component not just for student success but for students to excel. This session will evaluate the importance of students feeling supported and valued, and the impact it can produce. Finally, we'll discuss a classroom activity designed to allow students to share with their peers the insight or discoveries that made course material comprehensible. In sharing their Eureka moments with peers, they are providing novice-to-novice information and connections, insight that an expert (i.e., the instructor) may not provide.

for what's next in the curriculum. These peer interactions not only **deepen understanding** but also build students' confidence in **explaining concepts**, thereby fostering a **collaborative** learning environment where everyone benefits from shared insights. In upper-level courses I have started to give quizzes that are very difficult, where students score an average of 50%. They take it once, get feedback only on incorrect questions, but are not given the correct answer. Then they get 10 minutes to discuss with anyone or everyone in class before taking the quiz again. I have found they really enjoy this and do significant peer teaching in the process.

As a techno geek, I embraced **Generative AI** early on, recognizing its potential to reshape higher education. I realized that the future does not lie in making assignments "AI-proof" but rather in **redesigning curricula and pedagogy** to leverage AI for **enhancing learning**. My commitment to this vision was solidified after attending the Assessment Institute Conference in Indianapolis, where I began reevaluating my approach to assessment. I view learning as a process, uniquely individualized for each student, where the journey matters as much as the final product. Inspired by a presentation by Tyler Corbridge, and a webinar describing professional growth, I revamped my PSYC275W (Social Science Writing) course. In this redesigned approach, students met in the Psychology Lab, where they used lab computers to begin each draft in class, bringing their prepared notes and materials. After working on their drafts, they submitted them to Dropbox. With each revision, they resubmitted updated drafts, allowing me to monitor their progress step by step through similarity reports. For their final drafts, I encouraged students to use AI tools to refine their writing. They submitted both the revised drafts and the corresponding chat logs, showcasing how they engaged with AI for improvements. This iterative process enabled students to receive detailed, tailored feedback beyond what I could provide alone. The AI offered insights such as identifying weak thesis statements, improving paragraph flow, and highlighting informal sections. One English major frequently asked to see her paragraphs restructured in various ways. She shared that this process of viewing her own words in unfamiliar formats taught her a great deal. Overall, incorporating AI into my teaching has greatly accelerated my students' learning to think, read, and write like scientists.

In that same semester, I expanded my use of AI tools to other courses, such as Neuroscience and Sensation & Perception, where I used AI to help students **grasp complex concepts**. For instance, when students struggled with ideas like ion flow during an action potential, they would ask AI to provide **analogies**, *explain it as if to a 6th grader*, or *describe it in various contexts*. They even requested examples from familiar sources like movies or music to make the concepts more relatable. This approach allowed students to engage with the material in multiple ways until they fully understood it, and the learning process was again **accelerated**. Interestingly, I recall as an undergraduate finding places in the textbook where I wanted more information but could not find it. AI can fill those gaps, and I encourage students to use it in this way. AI can generate innumerable examples and contexts, that promote deep understanding, something that the instructor alone cannot do.

While earlier AI models had issues with "hallucinating" (i.e., generating incorrect information), newer versions are far more reliable, and future AI tools will only continue to improve. Given this trajectory, we must acknowledge that in the near future, people will have instantaneous access to nearly any piece of information they seek. This shift fundamentally changes the role of education. Traditionally, a significant part of teaching focused on **memorization**, but with information so readily accessible, the emphasis now needs to be on how students **use that information**. The priority should shift toward developing **critical thinking** skills, the ability to verify the accuracy of information (whether provided by AI or other sources), and practical skills in effectively using AI tools. This approach not only prepares students for

the future but also **empowers** them to become independent, resourceful thinkers who can navigate a world where information is abundant, but discernment is key.

In summary, reflecting on my annual evaluations paints a picture of change. My approach to teaching has undergone a significant transformation from a traditional lecture-based approach to an experimental, student-centered methodology. Early challenges in adapting to innovative practices gave way to a passion for exploring diverse strategies that enhance engagement and learning. By leveraging tools like detailed course logs, peer instruction, and collaborative activities, I have created interactive and dynamic classroom environments. I integrate evidence-based methods, such as peer-sharing and structured feedback opportunities, to foster deeper connections between students and the material. Embracing technological advancements, particularly generative AI, has further enabled me to personalize and accelerate learning while preparing students for a rapidly evolving world. Through these efforts, I aim to empower students to not only absorb information but also critically analyze and apply it, equipping them with the skills necessary for lifelong learning and success. I feel that there is sufficient evidence presented above to support the notion that I am **dynamic**, committed to **change**, and passionate about improving.

A note on qualitative student evaluations

I have been told that my reflections in annual self-evaluation are commendable, and so a full discussion can be found in that document. But since the Midpro, students generally appreciate my teaching, but some feedback highlights opportunities for growth.

One area for improvement is classroom organization. Students have noted that they could benefit from improved organization and clearer alignment between assignments, lectures, and assessments. Additionally, some students have expressed that my responses to their questions can be overly technical or advanced, which may hinder their comprehension. There is also a desire for a better balance between structured learning and interactive, hands-on experiences to increase engagement across different class sizes and formats. These observations are fair and align with the challenges inherent to teaching diverse courses. I am actively addressing these areas by experimenting with more effective methods, such as integrating more interactive elements, refining my course organization, and ensuring clarity in communication with students. My goal is to show that these elements have improved in my next review.

On the other hand, the feedback also reflects many positive aspects of my teaching. Students frequently highlight my ability to connect theoretical material to real-world applications, foster critical thinking, and provide supportive guidance. Many students commend my engaging and lively teaching style, which makes complex topics accessible and interesting. Furthermore, the overall feedback suggests that I have successfully fostered a productive and enriching environment that prioritizes student growth and understanding. My goal is to continue improving these points and establish other areas of strength.

How I keep content and pedagogy current and up to date

I keep textbooks up to date and change them when necessary. I incorporate current primary literature in many classes for two purposes. First to expose students to modern trends in the respective area, and secondly to scaffold the development of finding, reading, and critical thinking of scientific literature. In addition, I also read many books in preparation for new courses and to keep current with new and old trends in science and pedagogy. Below is a selected list of my readings by topic.

Artificial Intelligence

- The Deep Learning Revolution by Terrence Sejnowski
- A Brief History of Intelligence: Evolution, AI, and the Five Breakthroughs That Made Our Brains by George Bennet
- Teaching and Learning with AI: A Practical Guide to a New Era of Human Learning by Jose Bowen and Edward Watson
- Co-Intelligence: Living and Working with AI by Ethan Mollick

Psychological Disorders

- Cognitive Behavioral Therapy by Jason Satterfield

Cognitive, Neuroscience, Sensation & Perception

- A History of the Brain: From the Sea Sponge to CRISPR—How Our Brain Evolved by Sean Pratt
- Eve: How the Female Body Drove 200 Million Years of Human Evolution by Cat Bohannon
- The Forgetting Machine: Memory, Perception, and the "Jennifer Aniston Neuron" by Rodrigo Quian Quiroga
- Survival of the Friendliest: Understanding Our Origins and Rediscovering Our Common Humanity by Brian Hare and Vanessa Woods
- Behave: The Biology of Humans at Our Best and Worst by Robert Sapolsky
- Biology of Human Behavior by Robert Sapolsky
- The Brain from Inside Out by György Buzsáki
- Soul of an Octopus: A Surprising Exploration into the Wonder of Consciousness by Sy Montgomery
- Being You: A New Science of Consciousness by Anil Seth
- Determined: A Science of Life Without Free Will by Robert Sapolsky
- The Intelligent Brain by Richard Haier
- Synthetic Biology: Life's Extraordinary New Worlds by Milton Muldrow
- The Epigenetics Revolution: How Modern Biology Is Rewriting Our Understanding of Genetics, Disease, and Inheritance by Nessa Carey
- Sensation and Perception and the Aging Process by Francis Colavita
- The Brain from Inside Out by György Buzsáki

- I Contain Multitudes: The Microbes Within Us and a Grand View of Life by Ed Yong
- Brain Bugs: How the Brain's Flaws Shape Our Lives by William Hughes
- Biology and Human Behavior: The Neurological Origins of Individuality (2nd Edition) by Robert Sapolsky
- Understanding the Secrets of Human Perception by Peter Vishton
- Why Zebras Don't Get Ulcers: The Acclaimed Guide to Stress, Stress-Related Diseases, and Coping by Robert Sapolsky
- Philosophy of Mind: Brains, Consciousness, and Thinking Machines by Patrick Grim
- Why We Sleep: Unlocking the Power of Sleep and Dreams by Matthew Walker

Animal Behavior

- Are We Smart Enough to Know How Smart Animals Are? by Frans de Waal

Theories of Emotion

- The Language of Mind by Spencer D. Kelly
- How Emotions Are Made by Lisa Feldman Barrett
- Understanding Human Emotions by Lawrence Ian Reed

Teaching Generally

- Teaching Tips: Strategies, Research, and Theory for College and University Teachers by Wilbert McKeachie
- The Effective Use of PowerPoint for Education by Gary D. Fisk
- Neurodiversity and the Myth of Normal by Kyler Shumway and Daniel Wendler
- The Modern Intellectual Tradition: From Descartes to Derrida by Lawrence Cahoon

Evidence of Satisfactory Teaching

- *Peer evaluations of teaching*
- *Examples of assignments and graded student work*
- *Examples of instructor's other course material or class design (for example, but not limited to, syllabi, handouts, rubrics, or other pedagogical materials)*
- *Other evidence*

Peer Evaluations of Teaching

Dr. Frank Sommers Evaluation ([link here](#))

Fall 2019 was my second semester at Columbia College. My faculty mentor Dr. Frank Sommer evaluated my General Psychology course. He suggested that I **effectively** used time. I was interactive and conversational, humorously incorporated material, and had an excellent rapport with students. Excellent even fancy slides. Showed videos and commented throughout. Noticed changes in student attention. Reviewed and foreshadowed. Covered a lot of material without being rushed or dry. I could have incorporated **book material** more explicitly (see examples of how I've improved on this below).

From that review, I began to think about how explicitly linking the textbook's material and structure to my teaching could better scaffold student learning. To achieve this, I started incorporating the book's structure, questions, and content directly into my presentations. While the general framework of most classes already aligns with the textbook, making these connections explicit helps validate and coordinate student thinking. By clearly showing how class material is nested within the textbook, students can more easily see the congruence between course materials and classroom instruction, which supports their understanding and engagement. Below are some examples.

- Chapter 9 [Conceptual Knowledge](#). **Cognitive Psychology**. Demonstrates integrating book material to nest discussion.
- Chapter 2 [Synapses](#). **Neuroscience**. Incorporates Stop and Check, Summaries, Questions, and quotes from the textbook.
- Chapter 1.2 [The Nerve Impulse](#). **Neuroscience**. Incorporates textbook material, but also demonstrates the attention to detail, media, and formatting used for difficult material.
- Chapter 5 [Perceiving Objects and Scenes](#). **Sensation & Perception**. Demonstrates media, organization, integrated discussion questions, and application to the real-world.

Dr. Moenes Mellouli Evaluation ([link here](#))

In the Fall of 2023, as part of the CTL's peer observation initiative, Dr. Moenes Mellouli observed my Cognitive Psychology class. His feedback highlighted a striking contrast to earlier observations of my teaching. Dr. Mellouli was enthusiastic about the class and particularly praised the interactive activities, such as the short quizzes where students first completed the quiz individually and then discussed their answers in groups. During the session, I noticed a lull in attention and spontaneously asked the class if they needed a quick break. The students agreed, so we stood up and walked goofy circles around the center group of tables in New Hall 132. Dr. Mellouli found this impromptu activity both creative and

engaging, emphasizing how it brought energy into the room and reinforced the dynamic atmosphere of the class.

"He spoke clearly and explained concepts in a very nice way. I was very happy with class and learned what was presented even though it was not my area of expertise."

*"Students were very **comfortable** asking Questions. They always spoke up whenever they had something to say."*

*"Loved the dynamics with this class, the interaction with the students. Class is so active, so alive. Love the group **activities** students can discuss the quizzes for feedback. Love the energy you bring to the class. Lots of real-life examples."*

I feel that this peer-evaluation describes an engaging class, that was fun and productive for both students and me. Adding further evidence to the administrative evaluations that my pedagogy has been quite progressive and effective.

Examples of instructor's other course material or class design

A list of materials provided previously in links but collated here:

1. [Statistics Icebreaker Prompts](#)
2. [Live Schedule and Roster](#)
3. PPTs integrating book material.
 - a. [Conceptual Knowledge](#), [Synapses](#), [The Nerve Impulse](#), [Perceiving Objects and Scenes](#).
4. [Eureka Moments](#)
 - a. Examples of Moments from some of my classes.

Other examples I did not describe previously:

5. [Guided Notes for Neuroscience](#) – Outlines
 - a. Example textbook outline assignment
6. See below
 1. [Final Exam Sensation and Perception](#)
 2. [Exam 1 Neuroscience](#)
 3. [Statistic Compendium](#)
7. [How to Study for General Psychology](#)
 - a. A document given to PSYC101 students, as they tend to have little experience or efficiency studying.

[Attempting to Assess in the Age of AI](#). In the age of AI, the ability to utilize and accurately assess information has become far more important than rote memorization. This perspective aligns closely with my longstanding belief that memorization has limited utility compared to conceptual understanding and practical application. While I had already been working to assess conceptual knowledge, the introduction of generative AI into the classroom made it clear that my current approach needed updating.

In response, I began teaching as conceptually as possible and redesigned my exams to align with the realities of AI-enhanced learning. The questions I now pose go beyond simple recall; having access to information alone is insufficient. Instead, students must apply concepts, synthesize ideas, take a stance, and support their arguments with evidence.

In this model, course material serves as a scaffold, helping students assimilate and synthesize new information. They are encouraged to actively seek out additional information to fill gaps in their understanding or expand on class discussions. Many of the exam questions are deliberately open-ended, reflecting real-world problems that cannot be solved with a single correct answer. These questions require students to critically engage with evidence and construct well-supported responses, fostering skills that are essential for navigating an AI-driven world.

See two examples of my exams

8. [Final Exam Sensation and Perception](#)
9. [Exam 1 Neuroscience](#)

To see how this works, [open this document](#), it contains the AI output for two questions one from each exam. By reading AI output two things become apparent, you cannot simply paste the output into a document and submit it as your own work. You must digest and understand, then synthesize with course material. I feel this demonstrates how AI serves not as a tool for cheating, but as an aid for understanding. It presents the Big Picture in which course material is nested, and pulling back what is pertinent for us leaves a framework that effectively organizes and cements those concepts that we need. It mirrors nicely my approach to teaching described above.

Support for exams from BIOL/PSYC 371 Neuroscience & 372 Sensation & Perception Spring 2023

"The exam format really helped me recall and have a deep understanding. Multiple choice and traditional exams I do not retain the information afterwards. Having the outlines done before lecture helped me learn the info and solidify it during class."

"He was very good at allowing various methods of learning and testing to take place. Very great. This allowed me to kind of customize the learning I got from the course Very fun course!"

"I enjoyed the way he tested us through the take home exams and the other alternate assignments that were interesting and different."

Building Statistics Compendium

With Dr. Hendrickson, our quantitative psychology faculty member, becoming Chair in Fall 2023 and going on sabbatical the following semester, our program needed someone to teach statistics. We had previously discussed the idea of someone else taking on the statistics course to give students the opportunity to benefit from Dr. Hendrickson's other areas of expertise. As a result, in the summer of 2024, I began preparing to teach BIOL/PSYC/SOCI 228 Statistics for Behavioral Sciences in the fall.

Having recently taught our senior capstone course, I approached this task with a clear sense of how the statistics course should prepare students for future challenges, like their capstone. I started by reading the textbook in detail but quickly realized that covering all the relevant chapters in a traditional way

would not leave enough time for students to actually *do* statistics the way they would in other courses or in the real world. I concluded that our students should focus on learning how to analyze data using statistical software and allow that to scaffold understanding of the underlying mechanisms such as probability distributions. In reviewing the literature, I found similar recommendations in a report by the American Statistical Association, which succinctly outlined best practices for teaching college-level statistics [see article](#). The main points were that we should:

- Teach statistical thinking
- Teach as an investigative process
- Focus on conceptual knowledge
- Integrate real data with context and purpose
- Use technology to explore and analyze data

So midway through my summer preparations, I switched gears. I approached the course goal to prepare them for other courses such as their senior capstone, and the real world after college. See an example [worksheet here](#), of the types of questions we tackled. It describes the variables and poses questions that can be tested.

Some of the main goals for the course were:

- Get students to think like a scientist, find, understand, and critique primary literature data.
- Practice analyzing data until rote, in both Excel (with toolpak) and R.
- Develop the ability to appropriately convert questions into tests and interpret results meaningfully.
- Develop and model the acquisition of further information regarding specifics that may arise in future work.
 - For instance, they know they need alpha adjustments of post-hoc comparisons. We used $\alpha / \#$ of comparisons (i.e., Bonferroni) as a placeholder, but they realize that when they have their own data in the future, they will need to research which method works best in that context.

This shift in approach created a dilemma: what materials would students need to support their learning? To address this gap, I began building a compendium—a curated reference of vetted information that I tailored to my students' needs. Over time, it evolved into a sort of textbook, which I believe showcases the instructional materials I create to support learning. See the [Statistics Compendium](#).

1.1.2 Teaching Achievements

Faculty members are expected to work toward and achieve a certain number of teaching achievements tied to each performance level. The annual self-evaluation and dossiers for tenure and promotion must reflect on and provide evidence for a faculty member's achievements. Teaching achievements can include but are not limited to:

- **Developing and / or teaching a new course outside of one's regularly assigned classes**
 - 17 courses
- **Development / incorporation of significant new pedagogical materials to enhance student learning**
 - Explored many courseware applications
 - Generative Artificial Intelligence
 - Live Notes, Schedule, Roster, and Group Quizzes
- **Attendance / participation in organized activities that contribute to teaching and course improvement**
 - McGraw-Hill Symposium
 - Show-Me Teaching of Psychology Conference 2024
- **Development / improvement of teaching techniques to enhance student learning**
 - Incorporating discussions, and activities
- **Supervising / assisting students in research or independent study**
 - Integrative Psychology – Capstone
 - Create method to advertise student research
- **Supervising internships**
 - Kaitlyn Weber Internship
- **Sharing teaching expertise with faculty in a formal setting**
 - Fall Faculty Conference Eureka Moments
- **Other evidence**
 - TATE Award

Developing and / or teaching a new course outside of one's regularly assigned classes

Since I started at Columbia College in the Fall of 2019, I have prepared 17 courses (seen in green to the right). Of those courses, 6 are cross listed with other departments. While I do feel quite capable of preparing courses, I always look forward to optimizing them.

Development / incorporation of significant new pedagogical materials to enhance student learning

I do feel that the teaching growth narrative above can inform this section as well, the Statistics Compendium, Eureka Moments, Live Schedule/Notes/Roster, Guided notes, Group quizzes, and so on. All represent new materials to enhance learning.

However, not previously mentioned, I have explored, implemented, and shared with other instructors many courseware applications. At first, I was interested in virtual labs for Cognitive Psychology, Neuroscience, and Sensation Perception using **Cengage's MindTap**.

When we changed textbooks for Psych 101, I integrated **MacMillan's Achieve** and iClicker and was able to share my expertise with Dr. Neilsen and Dr. DeBord.

Since **generative AI** hit the academic scene, I have been an advocate. As described above, I began implementing AI in the Spring of 2023. As of now, I essentially incorporate AI into every class. I model using it in class, how to corroborate output, which AI's to use for which purposes (e.g., those that provide links like [CoPilot](#), or those that use databases of primary literature like [perplexity](#)).

Expanding on my exams described above, I do **activities in-class** using AI. Students think, ask AI, then pair with a classmate, and finally share insights with the class. By think-pair-sharing in this way, we are able to create a consensus through discussion of the key takeaways. Consider the following table from a textbook regarding Dopamine functions: *influence movement, learning, attention, and emotion*. One would have to flashcard the words and still never understand enough to make sense and remember.

List of Courses. Green = New Preparation.

Fall 2019

101 General Psychology
101 General Psychology
[304 Personality](#)
[450 Psychological Disorders](#)

Fall 2020

101 General Psychology
[233 Mind, Brain, & Behavior](#)
330 Lifespan Development
[220 Cognitive Psychology](#)

Fall 2021

101 General Psychology
[275W Social Science Writing](#)
220 Cognitive Psychology
330 Lifespan Development

Fall 2022

101 General Psychology (New Book)
[270 Psychology of Emotion](#)
220 Cognitive Psychology
330 Lifespan Development

Fall 2023

[275W Social Science Writing](#)
[333 Human Evolution BIOL\PSYC](#)
220 Cognitive Psychology
[328 Independent Study](#)
[101 Online General Psychology](#)

Fall 2024

[224 Statistics Behavioral/Natural](#)
101 General Psychology
220 Cognitive Psychology
330 Lifespan Development

Spring 2020

101 General Psychology
101 General Psychology
[372 Sensation & Perception BIOL\PSYC](#)
[371 Neuroscience BIOL\PSYC](#)

Spring 2021

101 General Psychology
[309 Animal Behavior BIOL\PSYC](#)
450 Psychological Disorders
371 Neuroscience BIOL\PSYC

Spring 2022

101 General Psychology
371 Neuroscience BIOL\PSYC
[410 Learning Theories](#)
[399 Internship](#)
372 Sensation & Perception BIOL\PSYC

Spring 2023

101 General Psychology
371 Neuroscience BIOL\PSYC
309 Animal Behavior BIOL\PSYC
450 Psychological Disorders

Spring 2024

[260 Applied Psychology](#)
[495W Integrative Capstone](#)
372 Sensation & Perception BIOL\PSYC
371 Neuroscience BIOL\PSYC

Spring 2025

[224 Statistics Behavioral/Natural](#)
[224 Statistics Behavioral/Natural](#)
309 Animal Behavior BIOL\PSYC
371 Neuroscience BIOL\PSYC

Neurotransmitter	Function
<i>Acetylcholine (ACh)</i>	Enables muscle action, learning, and memory
<i>Dopamine</i>	Influences movement, learning, attention, and emotion
<i>Serotonin</i>	Affects mood, hunger, sleep, and arousal

But if we ask AI:

- Question 1: *How was the neurotransmitter dopamine used in the first bilaterally symmetrical species, and how does that inform our understanding of its function in humans?*
- Question 2: *Can those functions inform our understanding of AI learning?*

[See the Response here.](#) Depending on the course, I would adjust the emphasis on the AI-related question. For example, in introductory courses like Psychology 101, I would simplify the content by leaving off Question 2. However, including Question 2 in my neuroscience course enhances deeper understanding. Since AI was engineered from our understanding of brain functions, like reward learning and distributed networks, in advanced courses where we focus on the brain, it provides the opportunity to reverse engineer those functions. A valuable complementary framework.

Referencing those keywords from the table: *influence movement, learning, attention, and emotion*. Through this exercise, we observe that dopamine originally helped the first bilaterally symmetrical organisms to navigate by choosing left or right (**movement**) and rewarded them for responding to cues that led to food (**learning**). In humans, this system is still rather simple, but functions in the context of sophisticated mental models of the world allowing us to function in time and space (also described by cognitive light cones in the exam question above). Dopamine directs **attention**, motivates with **emotion**, and **learns** from reward.

The broader point is that this approach allows us to see the bigger picture of how the course material connects to foundational biological and cognitive processes. Instead of memorizing isolated terms or concepts, students can engage in sense-making and develop integrated knowledge structures. These connections reduce the need for rote repetition, like using flashcards, and encourage deeper understanding and retention.

[Attendance / participation in organized activities that contribute to teaching and course improvement](#)

In the Spring of 2022, I attended a **Psychology Symposium** put on by McGraw-Hill in Nashville. This 3-day event brought 14 Psychology professors from different areas of the US together. This included one of my neuroscience graduate instructors from MU, with whom I am planning cross-campus collaboration in the future. Over the 3 days, we tested new course materials, proposed solutions of common issues within General Psychology, and brainstormed about pedagogy. Not being the most extraverted person, I was a bit uncertain, but all expenses paid got me out the door and it was a wonderful experience. I look forward to future opportunities. I do feel that the experience left me with a network of people with whom I do communicate, and a positive, rejuvenated, validated attitude toward teaching.

Show-Me Teaching of Psychology Conference Fall 2024. All the psychology faculty took a road trip to St. Louis to meet with other psychology educators from Missouri. What I took away was a new Group Quiz technique, in which students take a quiz, then discuss with others, and retake the quiz. The average score of the two is recorded. It makes low stakes quizzing a learning process and is fun. I have modified this approach and incorporated it into classes. I also took away a new appreciation for how other faculty are struggling with generative AI. They want to AI-proof their assignments, which simply is not possible. But my thoughts are maturing on what is possible and I am eager to share.



Development / improvement of teaching techniques to enhance student learning

As described above, one aspect of my teaching that I have been particularly focused on is creating more **discussion** in the classroom. I feel that the recent evaluations from [Moenes Mellouli](#), [Aurelien Mauxion](#), [Gretchen Hendrickson](#), support the notion that I am improving toward this goal. Additional support comes from a **promotional video** ([click to watch](#)) filmed in my classroom, where Ann Lemerande highlights how interactive and discussion-based psychology classes are. While the video promotes all psychology faculty, it specifically features my class, with me leading a discussion.



Some Student Comments

- Sensation & Perception, 2023
 - *"Made class very intriguing and did not just read off a powerpoint. Engaged in conversation and communicated with class."*
 - *"Dr. Oxford comes to class every day prepared and excited to discuss course material. He knows the material so well that he often describes the knowledge on the following slide, even before getting to it. He proposes interesting questions in class and on exams, encouraging us to think deeply and outside of the box, relating simple topics to other courses or connecting ideas in a new way. He also encourages our questions in class in a way that gets many of my peers involved in discussion. He is very thorough, and his attention to detail easily shows how much time and effort he puts into his classes. He created a new style for quizzes, allowing us to not stress but also bringing in class concepts and increasing our confidence on the material. I really liked the exam style and the class as a whole."*
 - *"Dr. Oxford is an extremely informed professor. He welcomes all questions within his classroom and encourages a surplus of classroom discussion. He definitely holds students*

accountable for their part of the learning process and coursework can be challenging but it is always very manageable, and he offers informative and helpful aids.”

Supervising / assisting students in research or independent study

When I taught the senior capstone course, I implemented a Google Document (see example [here](#)) to streamline communication and management of ongoing student research projects. Previously, students had to individually contact each instructor to recruit participants, and instructors would then post separate announcements for each study, for example in D2L. With 15 studies starting and stopping at different times, this approach became cumbersome and inefficient for instructors. To address this, I centralized the process by creating a shared Google Document that listed all active research studies, along with their status and participation details. This document was managed by the instructor overseeing the capstone research and was linked directly to other instructors' D2L course shells. By maintaining and updating the document as needed, this system eliminated the administrative burden on other instructors while ensuring students had a clear and accessible way to recruit participants for their research, significantly enhancing the overall process.

Below is a Shout Out for facilitating student research.

◆ Special thanks to psychology instructors **Dr. Jon Oxford, Dr. Blake Nielsen, and Dr. Gretchen Hendrickson** for sponsoring several presentations at the Tenth Annual Science Symposium! A round of applause for everyone who contributed to this remarkable event!



Supervising internships

In Spring 2022, I supervised Katelyn Weber's internship with a therapeutic horse-riding program for individuals with autism. She checked in with me weekly to share updates and reflections on her experiences. As part of her internship, she wrote a paper integrating psychological theories with her practical work, exploring concepts such as sensory integration, behavior modification, and emotional regulation. This process helped her connect academic knowledge with real-world applications, demonstrating the value of experiential learning in deepening understanding and professional growth.

Sharing teaching expertise with faculty in a formal setting

There was a comment in my MidPro feedback that it was impressive for junior faculty to share expertise with other faculty formally, and at that time I had only shared the Eureka Moments presentation for the Fall Faculty Conference in 2022 which was described in teaching growth.

As of now, I have presented for the Center for Teaching and Learning twice in 2023, and again at the Fall Faculty Council in 2024, a poster presentation, and faculty learning community. Those will be elaborated later.

Other Evidence of Teaching Achievement

I was the 2024 recipient of the Trustees Achievement in Teaching Award (TATE).



Service Growth Exhibits: Eureka Moments

2022 Fall Faculty Conference

Breakout Session B: Community Building & Eureka Moments



Dr. Sandy Hamar
Associate Professor of
Education



Dr. Jon Oxford
Assistant Professor of
Psychology



Dr. Heidi Monroe
Assistant Professor of
Nursing

Room: DOR 107

Join us to discuss techniques to start relationship building immediately, connecting with your students, and using 'eureka moments' for peer-to-peer sharing. This session highlights some quick methods for building community, getting to know your students, and setting them (and yourself) up for success. We'll show how connections are a crucial component not just for student success but for students to excel. This session will evaluate the importance of students feeling supported and valued, and the impact it can produce. Finally, we'll discuss a classroom activity designed to allow students to share with their peers the insight or discoveries that made course material comprehensible. In sharing their Eureka moments with peers, they are providing novice-to-novice information and connections, insight that an expert (i.e., the instructor) may not provide.

1.2 Professional Growth

Each year, faculty members are expected to remain current in the content, the pedagogy, the technical, performative or artistic aspects of their teaching areas, or other areas of professional responsibilities (for example, assessment work or administrative responsibilities such as being a department chair).

Professional growth is reflected through two components: a baseline of professional growth and a certain number of professional growth achievements tied to each performance level.

1.2.1 Baseline Professional Growth

A baseline level of professional growth is established by a written narrative that reflects on and provides evidence for how a faculty member has stayed current professionally, through such activities as:

- **Professional memberships**
 - APA, APS
- **Attendance at conferences, lectures, talks, workshops, training sessions, etc.**
 - Various, elaborated below
- **Webinars**
 - Various, elaborated below
- **Other activities that a faculty member feels demonstrates a baseline of professional growth.**
 - Cougar Conversations
 - Lunch with Faculty at Dulaney
 - Inclusive reading group

In this section, I used a combination of outlining and expanding the most influential components to avoid excessive elaboration.

Professional memberships

- American Psychological Association (APA) from Spring 2021
- Sub-division: Society for Teaching of Psychology from Fall 2021
- Association for Psychology Science (APS) from Spring 2022
- Sub-division: Behavior, Neuroscience, and Comparative 2022
- Sub-division: Teaching of Psychological Science from 2022

Attendance at conferences, lectures, talks, workshops, training sessions, etc.

Fall 2021

- **American Psychological Association (APA)** Conference Virtual
- [Focus on Teaching and Technology Conference](#) by the CTL at University of Missouri – St. Louis
- [Remote: the Connected Faculty Summit](#) by Arizona State University
- **Oklahoma Center of Evolutionary Analysis (OCEAN)** is a lab run by one of my graduate school mates Jennifer Byrd-Craven that hosts talks on Evolutionary Psychology topics. I began attending talks in the fall of 2021.
 - In Fall 2021, I attended a talk by Sarah Hill on the impact of women's hormones and hormonal contraception on women's health. This topic was particularly interesting to me because, during my postdoctoral research, I observed that women on hormonal birth control did not exhibit the typical fluctuations in estradiol, testosterone, and cortisol in response to social competition. This phenomenon, which has received very little attention in the published literature, deeply troubled me. I have considered building a research program to explore this issue further.

Spring 2022

- **Remote: The Connected Faculty Summit** by Arizona State University
- Writing Across the Curriculum at CC

Fall 2022

- **When Can Psychological Science Be Useful in Educational Policy and Practice? The Case of COVID-19 and College Admissions Processes**, hosted by the Association for Psychological Science (APS). The discussion was particularly engaging as it explored alternatives to purely empirical admission criteria, a topic relevant to our Honors Program. Our program has already adopted such alternatives, and as chair of that committee we recently revised those criteria for the upcoming fall semester.
- **Rebuilding Trust in Science**. Panel discussion by American Psychological Association. An important topic following COVID-19 when the public appeared to lose trust in science.

Spring 2023

- Course Heros Education Summit

- [Evolution and the Social Sciences](#) is a lecture series hosted by the University of Missouri's biology program. I was added to the group and began attending talks in the Fall of 2022.
 - Fall of 2022, I attended a talk by David Puts from Penn State Anthropology discussing the evolution and neurodevelopment of sexual differentiation, the biological mechanisms and evidence gleaned from genetic or congenital deviations.
 - Spring of 2023 I attended a talk by [MU's Carol Ward](#) is a leading researcher on hominin (i.e., apes to humans) anatomical evolution. Her talk forms the basis of some of my own publications on hominin life history evolution (i.e., the pattern of development across the lifespan, related to developmental psychology).

Fall 2023

- **Pushing the Boundaries of Critical Thinking: What's Next in the Era of Generative AI?"** hosted by the American Psychological Association. The panel explored how tools like ChatGPT are transforming the landscape of higher education, prompting me to reassess my approach to student learning in the age of AI. This discussion aligned closely with insights I gained from the Indianapolis Assessment Institute conference, where both experiences encouraged me to rethink strategies for assessing student learning. Generative AI adds a new dimension, shifting the focus away from rote memorization toward fostering expertise, creativity, and the ability to critically evaluate AI-generated output. This shift is now central to how I envision preparing students for success in an AI-driven world.
- I completed **TONIC training** and taught my first online class, an experience that was both eye-opening and challenging. While I had redeveloped PSYC 101 for the online format, I quickly realized I had underestimated the unique demands and nuances of online education. This experience intersected with my evolving thoughts on the impact of AI on teaching, raising significant concerns about how online education is currently approached. Dr. Nielsen, who was also teaching his first online course at the same time, shared similar concerns. Although my ideas for the future of online education are still in their infancy and may take time to fully mature, this experience has deepened my understanding of the problem space and highlighted areas that need attention.

Spring 2023

- **Power Teaching** a workshop put on by CC Center for Teaching and Learning (CTL)
- **Spaced Learning** a workshop put on by CC Center for Teaching and Learning (CTL)

Spring 2024

- I attended the **Society for the Teaching of Psychology Conference** virtually and gained some insights about novel approaches to pedagogy. My primary interest was largely how others are dealing with AI, my takeaway was that most instructors having difficulty thinking outside the box and more work is needed.

- The CTL sponsored an AI expert to come speak at CC, **Dr Jose Antonio Bowen**. His talk AI is Transforming the Classroom Average introduced a diverse array of AI emphasizing that there is more to explore than simply ChatGPT, he had us try others and get hands on experience. Another emphasis was that premium models, or subscription models, are vastly superior to the free versions. That is something that I have found to be true myself. I have used Professional Development funds to maintain access to ChatGPT 4.0. I am a technophile and explore every opportunity to utilize new technologies. Seeing the difference with GPT 4.0 several of the members of the learning community that I led this spring did the same. Recently I switched to CoPilot Pro which is built on GPT 4.0, but also integrates into my Microsoft suite, and has many other benefits. Sadly, as CC does not allow our email accounts to work with AI systems, I must pay for the Office subscription out of pocket to have access to the bleeding edge technology.
- **A Conversation Between Two Arab American Women**, a talk organized by Dean Jewel at CC. The dialogue featured two Arab American women with contrasting upbringings and family histories, highlighting both the diversity and shared experiences of Arabs in America. The discussion illuminated common misconceptions about defining the term "Arab" and emphasized the significant cultural, historical, and geographical diversity among Arabs worldwide. This talk provided valuable insights into the multifaceted identities and experiences within the Arab community. It was a valuable experience for my students and myself.
- **Provost Programming Workshop** at CC. We examine the formula for assessing academic programs, with an eye toward identifying problems.

Webinars

Fall 2020

- **The Art and Science of Survival During the Pandemic,”** presented by McGraw-Hill and delivered by Dr. Laura King, who was my graduate instructor for personality psychology and is the author of the textbook I use for PSYC 101. She shared insights about finding happiness even during challenging times. Her central message was that happiness can be found in both good times and bad—it simply requires us to notice and appreciate it. Her perspective was both thought-provoking and deeply relevant during the ongoing challenges of the pandemic.

Spring 2021

- **Transitioning to a Post-Pandemic World: How can Psychological Science Assist Others and Us as Psychologists?** Virtual Townhall. American Psychological Association.

Spring 2022

- **Town hall on the impact of COVID-19 on college students.** American Psychological Association. Discussion about trends emerging in higher education, and the implications for both current and future student outcomes.

- **Cognition at the Frontiers of Emotion and Neuroscience Webinar.** Hosted by Oxford University Press, this webinar explores the latest research at the intersection of cognition, emotion, and neuroscience. It highlights how brain imaging techniques like fMRI and EEG reveal the neural mechanisms of emotional processing and its impact on cognition. This webinar supported my approach to the course I was preparing on Theories of Emotion, providing insights into how emotions influence attention, memory, decision-making, and mental health interventions.
- **AI and Higher Ed: The Leadership Perspective.** Presented by The Chronicle of Higher Education and Microsoft, this discussion emphasized the evolving role of AI in education. It prompted reflection on how AI can address areas with limited existing literature while highlighting the skills humans must cultivate to complement AI. The takeaway is that education should prioritize creative thinking, connectionist approaches, and problem-solving over rote memorization—areas where AI struggles. For instance, instead of focusing on the mechanics of mathematics, the emphasis should shift to applying mathematical principles to real-world problems.

Fall 2022

- **In the Driver's Seat: Preparing Students for AI-Enhanced Workplaces.** A panel discussion hosted by MacMillan Learning sparked important reflections on equipping students with the skills needed for AI-integrated workplaces, something mirrored by a student comment at the Cougar Conversations in which I participated. The key takeaway was the dual role of AI in skill development: it can reduce performance gaps between top and bottom performers but risks exacerbating inequity if access and training are unequal. This idea has influenced my approach to fostering discussions with faculty about the importance of understanding AI's capabilities. Educators need to develop significant AI-related skills to effectively use it in enhancing education while addressing equity concerns. These insights will shape how I guide students and faculty in navigating the evolving demands of AI-enhanced environments.

Spring 2023

- **Academic Integrity and AI.** A talk by The Chronicle of Higher Education emphasized the importance of assessing the learning process rather than the final product, especially in an AI-integrated classroom. While AI can generate polished outputs, meaningful learning occurs during the process of creation. This idea became the foundation for designing my first AI-enhanced, writing-intensive course. I later presented a poster on this approach. The experience highlighted that while AI can significantly enhance learning, traditional assessment methods must evolve to better reflect the developmental aspects of student work.
- **Why This Class Matters: From Discovering to Doing.** A panel discussion by MacMillan Learning highlighted the importance of showing students how their learning applies to real-world contexts. It also explored strategies for shifting the focus from theoretical knowledge to practical application, emphasizing the role of relevance in fostering student motivation.

Fall 2023

- **Pushing the Boundaries of Critical Thinking: What's Next in the Era of Generative AI?** A panel discussion by the American Psychological Association inspired deeper reflection on the

capabilities and limitations of AI. The conversation emphasized that with information readily available, critical thinking becomes the key skill—especially in discerning where AI falters, such as its tendency to hallucinate information. Expertise remains essential for identifying these errors, but developing expertise is challenging without direct engagement with information. This led to a policy in my courses requiring students to corroborate AI-generated information with primary sources whenever possible. This process not only promotes elaborative learning, which accelerates expertise and enhances recall, but also holds students accountable for using AI wisely. These ideas have become a cornerstone of my AI-integrated teaching approach.

- **Embracing the Power of Generative AI.** A panel by Cengage explored the need to rethink assessment methods in the age of AI. A key takeaway was the potential for non-text-based assessments, such as video discussion boards and oral exams, to evaluate student understanding more effectively. The discussion also touched on the challenges of creating equitable and effective AI policies. This panel influenced my thinking about AI policy and assessment, highlighting the importance of proactive strategies in education. As my views on AI continue to evolve, I see the need for institutions, including CC, to **lead rather than react** to the challenges posed by generative AI.

Spring 2024

- **A Whole New World: Exploring AI's Impact on Future Pathways of Education.** A MacMillan Learning webinar that explored the ethical challenges posed by AI, including handling unethical use in education. This discussion contributed to my realization that **AI-proof assignments** are unrealistic. Instead, assessments should be redesigned to minimize the potential for cheating by being inherently incompatible with misuse of AI tools.
- **Threading the Needle: Cultivating Ethical and Inclusive Teaching in an AI Era.** In this MacMillan webinar, we examined ways to promote ethical AI use in classrooms, focusing on adjusting expectations to assume AI will be used and designing assignments accordingly. Discussions highlighted AI's potential to accelerate learning, making it a valuable tool when integrated thoughtfully into educational practices.
- **Science for Society: AI Buzz: What's Not New.** A panel hosted by the Association for Psychological Science (APS) addressed types of large language models (LLMs) and their classroom applications. Key themes included moving from product-based to process-based assessment—an approach I adopted when redesigning PSYC275W. The panel also discussed inequities in access to premium AI tools, emphasizing the need to address disparities that give wealthier students an advantage.
- **EmpowerED: Navigating Generative AI in Higher Education.** A McGraw-Hill webinar discussing AI's transformative potential in higher education, alongside challenges in integrating it effectively. This session reinforced the importance of adapting teaching methods and addressing barriers to equitable AI access to ensure its benefits are broadly shared.

Some of these webinar and workshop activities can be found at the bottom of my Professional Exhibits document (linked at the bottom of Professional Growth Achievements).

Other activities that a faculty member feels demonstrates a baseline of professional growth.

In the fall of 2023, I served as a panelist for **Cougar Conversations** focused on AI. I was able to bring one of my students, Ann Lemerande, that embraced AI in my social science writing course to serve as the student panelist. The interesting point to come from that conversation was the notion that if we are not teaching AI to students then they will be disadvantaged in the job market, in which AI is already a highly desired skill.

Lunch with faculty at Dulaney. In Fall 2023, an idea emerged from our weekly meetings, and we hosted a luncheon at Dulany Hall that brought together students and faculty from the fields of human services, political science, psychology, and sociology. This event provided an opportunity for current majors and minors to connect with faculty members in their disciplines and for prospective students to learn more about these programs, including potential career paths. Given its success, this luncheon will be repeated in future semesters to continue fostering engagement and exploration within these fields.

Inclusive Reading Group: Spring 2023. In Spring 2023, I participated in an Inclusive Reading Group that met several times in the afternoon to discuss *What Do Inclusive Instructors Do?* by Addy et al. (2021). These informal discussions prompted me to reflect on ways to make my syllabus more inclusive. As a result, I incorporated a personal bio and adjusted the text to be more conversational, aiming to create a welcoming and accessible tone for students.



1.2.2 Professional Growth Achievements

Faculty members are expected to work toward and achieve a certain number of professional growth achievements tied to each performance level. The annual self-evaluation and dossiers for tenure and promotion must reflect on and provide evidence for a faculty member's achievements. Professional growth achievements can include but are not limited to:

- **Publication of discipline-specific work**
 - Prolactin: Impacts of Fatherhood (Columbia College student co-author)
 - Testosterone: Digit Ratios
 - Testosterone: Paternal Investment
- **Active participation in discipline specific conferences, workshops, or institutes**
 - Teaching of Psychology Conference
- **Judge or juror for an exhibit, competition, conference, or performance event**
 - Science Symposium
- **Visiting or invited talks, lectures, or performances**
 - Evolutionary Ecology lecture, University of Missouri (MU)
- **Funding received to support teaching, scholarly, or creative work**
 - Assessment Conference
- **Supervising/assisting students in research or independent study**
 - Anna Clayborn Independent Study
- **Service as a reviewer for a journal, book publisher, or grant**
 - Textbook reviews
 - Courseware reviews
- **Other evidence**
 - Deans Award for Scholarship

Publication of discipline-specific work

Oxford, J., & Clayborn, A. (2023). [Prolactin: Impacts of Fatherhood](#). In Shackelford, T. K. (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

- Notice Anna Clayborn is an Undergraduate at Columbia College. She wanted to go to graduate school in Neuroscience, but did not have research opportunities. So, I thought that publishing would help her stand out.

Oxford, J., & Oxford, D. N. (2022). [Testosterone: Digit ratios](#). In Shackelford, T. K. (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Oxford, J., & Oxford, D. N. (2022). [Testosterone: Paternal Investment](#). In Shackelford, T. K. (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Active participation in discipline specific conferences, workshops, or institutes

I presented a poster titled "Teaching Science Writing with AI" at the Society for the Teaching of Psychology, detailing my initial efforts to integrate AI into the Social Science Writing course (PSYC275W). The poster highlighted strategies for using AI to enhance students' writing skills, promote critical thinking, and address ethical considerations. It outlined workflows for incorporating AI feedback into the writing process while maintaining academic integrity and fostering equity. This work aimed to prepare students for a competitive, AI-driven environment and shared actionable insights for educators in psychology. The poster can be found [here](#).

Judge or juror for an exhibit, competition, conference, or performance event

In the Spring of 2024, I was a judge for the Columbia College Science Symposium. I had attended previous semesters to support our students, but had not actively attended all the presentations, I was surprised by the diversity of disciplines represented, especially in forensics. In addition, all my capstone students presented their work at this event.

Visiting or invited talks, lectures, or performances

[MU Evolutionary Ecology](#) Guest Lecture Spring 2024. I gave a lecture discussing primates and hominin evolution – one of my specialty areas. The class was Evolutionary Ecology, Biological Sciences Department. The instructor did not feel prepared to teach this topic and invited me. See the [presentation here](#).

Funding received to support teaching, scholarly, or creative work

Indiana University Assessment Institute, Fall 2022. I attended the Indiana University Assessment Institute, a funded opportunity that profoundly influenced my perspective on teaching and assessment. Until this point in my career, I had primarily followed traditional assessment methods—four exams and chapter quizzes—without fully reflecting on their effectiveness. This experience challenged me to reevaluate how I assess knowledge and focus on capturing the unique learning journey of each student. I had noticed a disconnect in many students who excelled in class assignments but then struggled on quizzes and exams, suggesting that traditional methods may fail to measure deep comprehension. True

learning should go beyond memorization and cramming, integrating knowledge to enhance reasoning and application. This led me to see students as active agents in their learning, fostering a vision of the classroom as a collaborative space where responsibility for learning and assessment is shared. By recognizing the diverse experiences and backgrounds students bring, I have attempted to shift toward a more personalized and meaningful approach to assessment, for instance the exams described above. This involves measuring the journey to understanding rather than relying solely on exam performance, emphasizing active engagement, application, and the development of reasoning skills. This realization has transformed both my teaching and my approach to fostering student growth.

[Supervising/assisting students in research or independent study](#)

In the Fall of 2023, I supervised Anna Clayborn in an **Independent Study**. She was interested in how childhood trauma impacts stress responses. Together, we devised a way to use heart rate variability (a measure of stress responsiveness) to examine stress reactions using the Trier Social Stress, a laboratory stressor involving public speaking.

Earlier that summer, **Anna coauthored** *Prolactin: Impacts of Fatherhood* with me. She was introduced to the process of writing and revising in a professional context. She learned about the process of finding and assessing sources, to produce a novel synthesis based on the current state of affairs in literature.

In addition to working with Anna, I discussed how I have worked to facilitate student research earlier in this document.

[Service as a reviewer for a journal, book publisher, or grant](#)

Spring 2023 took part in a focus group **reviewing** a new textbook for MacMillan Fuligni/Fuligni/Bayne *Scientific American: Lifespan Development* and the Achieve courseware. Our portion of the process was three chapters of the text, and providing feedback on the digital materials associated in the Achieve courseware.

Spring 2023. I was contacted by McGraw-Hill, likely because of my previous collaborations with them. Since I had used their Connect courseware, they had developed a new approach called **Relevancy Modules**. These are short lessons that attempt to provide students with highlights from the respective book and application to the real-world. These would be used in addition to the book and courseware. I agreed to review and provide feedback on many different modules.

Spring 2020 I was contacted by Cengage to review their new **MindTap** courseware. I was asked to use the courseware for several chapters and provide feedback about how it could be improved.

Other evidence

Fall of 2023 I received the **Dean's Award for Scholarship** resulting from the three publications of that year. [Link to CC connected](#) with announcement.



Link to [Professional Growth Achievements Exhibits](#)

1.3.1 Baseline Service Work

A baseline level of service work is established by a written narrative that reflects on and provides evidence for the faculty member's active and sustained participation in the work of the college, through such activities as:

- **Service on standing committees of the Faculty Association**
 - HASS CAP 2020
 - EPD 21-22
 - H&A 22-23
 - AFRS 2023
 - IFRS 21-22
- **Participation in college-wide advising and admission events, connections, preview days, scholarship days, academic showcases, and prospective student meetings**
 - 3 Registration Day events
 - Attended Quest Day
 - Psych Week Event
- **Work with assigned advisees**
 - On average 8 advisees per year
 - Attended workshops for advising
- **Help with the work of the department by contributing to assessment reports, program reviews, updates to master syllabi, approval of online developments and redevelopments, etc.**
 - Weekly Program Meetings
 - Mentoring new faculty
 - Involved in creation of new 5-year assessment cycle
 - 4 Master Syllabi updates
 - Approver of 3 online courses
 - Redeveloped Psychology 101 online
- **Other activities that a faculty member feels demonstrates a baseline of service activity**
 - Review adjunct applications
 - 2 TRiO presentations
 - Reader for Honor's program
 - 25+ Letters of Recommendation

Service on standing committees of the Faculty Association

- Humanities and Social Science Curriculum and Academic Policy Committee 2020
- Elections and Professional Development Committee 2021-2022
- Instructional Facilities, Resources and Support Committee 2021-2022
- Academic Facilities, Resources and Support Committee Spring 2023
- Academic Honors and Awards Committee 2022-2023

Participation in college-wide advising and admission events, connections, preview days, scholarship days, academic showcases, and prospective student meetings

- Spring 2021 Virtual Registration Day
- Spring 2022 Spring Registration Event
- Fall 2022 Registration Day Event
- Spring 2024, I attended Quest Day with my oldest son. While I was not working, I was able to see how the students are experiencing the events.
- Psych Week Event Fall of 2019. The psychology program and career services created a weeklong program of events such as a virtual career fair, graduate school panel, alumni panel, and a visit to Burrell Behavioral Health for those that were able to attend.

Work with assigned advisees

Over the past several semesters, I have consistently advised an average of eight students per term. While this work is highly rewarding, it also requires significant time and effort to ensure that each advisee receives personalized guidance to meet their academic and career goals. Some of the highlights working with my advisees was a publication, an internship, and an independent study. When Dr. Neilsen was on leave, I stepped in to assist with advising his students. In 2024 I attended training sessions for advising and training tools like Stellic.

Help with the work of the department

When I joined the department, it was in the midst of a period of rebuilding and reimagining. Dr. Neilsen and Dr. Hendrickson had already begun revitalizing the program, laying the foundation for a more cohesive and forward-thinking approach to psychology education. From the start, **weekly program meetings** and summer retreats have been a cornerstone of this effort, providing a structured and consistent space to share updates, address challenges, and collaboratively work toward our shared vision for the program. For instance, one initiative was to require a biological component for the Major, something that some students had avoided.

One of my earliest contributions to the department, from 2019 to the summer of 2020, was collaborating with colleagues to completely **redesign the 5-year assessment cycle** ([link to see our plan](#)). This process involved developing entirely new assessment instruments and creating detailed timelines to track and evaluate student progression throughout the degree program. Our goal was to ensure that the assessments not only measured learning outcomes effectively but also provided meaningful data to inform curricular improvements. The quality and thoroughness of this work were recognized and appreciated by Suzanne Tourville, particularly during preparations for the Higher Learning Commission (HLC) accreditation process.

As part of this ongoing process, we expanded the team by welcoming Dr. Kurt Debord and, more recently, Dr. Kruti Surti, whose addition brought new perspectives to our discussions. In these weekly meetings, we have tackled essential aspects of the program, such as conducting program self-review, planning assessments, preparing for HLC visits, and addressing other key priorities. This collaborative approach has strengthened the program, fostering a culture of reflection, innovation, and excellence.

In Spring 2022, I updated the **master syllabi** for several courses that bridge biology and psychology, including Neuroscience (BIOL/PSYC 371), Sensation and Perception (BIOL/PSYC 372), Psychopharmacology (PSYC 472), and Animal Behavior (BIOL/PSYC 309). These updates were designed to align course objectives and content with current trends in the field, enhancing their value for both psychology and biology students.

In the Spring of 2023, I met with MacMillan representatives to explore their **Achieve** and **iClicker** platforms. Over the course of three one-hour sessions, I gained a deep understanding of these tools and their potential applications for enhancing student engagement and learning outcomes. Recognizing their value, I arranged an additional session during one of our weekly meetings to demonstrate these platforms to Dr. Neilsen and Dr. Debord about how they could be integrated into our courses. This effort not only expanded my own expertise but also supported my colleagues in considering innovative tools for their teaching.

Regarding Online Classes

My first exposure to our online psychology program came in 2020, when I served as the **approver** for the redevelopment of Lifespan Psychology (PSYC 330). This initial experience was followed by approving updates for Sensation and Perception (BIOL/PSYC 372) and Psychological Disorders (PSYC 250). These roles allowed me to contribute to shaping the quality and consistency of our online offerings.

In the summer of 2023, I took on a more hands-on role by **redeveloping our PSYC 101** course. I further deepened my understanding of online instruction by **teaching PSYC 101 online** during Fall 2023. These experiences provided valuable insights into the strengths and challenges of our online program, helping us better understand its role in the psychology curriculum.

As our department evolves, we are exploring ways to adapt our program to stay relevant and competitive. The addition of Dr. Kruti Surti, a fully remote psychology faculty member, has been a key step in this direction. Weekly communication between our program and Dr. Surti has sparked important conversations about the future of our online program, including addressing critical issues such as AI usage in coursework and the effectiveness of discussion boards for fostering engagement.

My experiences with developing, teaching, and approving online courses, combined with ongoing collaboration with Dr. Surti and the other faculty, positions us to innovate and address the challenges of online education in the rapidly changing landscape of higher education.

Other activities that a faculty member feels demonstrates a baseline of service activity

Throughout my time at Columbia College, I have embraced numerous opportunities to contribute to the department and institution in meaningful ways. For example, I have been asked to review **adjunct applications** for the department on several occasions. In one instance, I leveraged my professional connections to reach out to a colleague at the University of Missouri, the graduate student coordinator in psychology, to identify a qualified instructor for our Psychopharmacology course. While this particular effort did not yield a candidate, it allowed me to rekindle a collaborative relationship with a long-time colleague. This connection has potential for future partnerships, as he had previously expressed interest in building links between our two programs.

As part of my service efforts, I have contributed to **TRiO programming**, presenting a talk [Ignite Your Future](#) in Spring 2022 to inspire and guide students in their educational and career aspirations. In Fall 2022, I delivered another presentation, [Not Too Little Too Late: The Psychological and Biological Underpinnings of Effective Learning in College](#), which offered practical, research-backed strategies to help students achieve academic success.

In my role as chair of the Academic Honors and Awards Committee, I developed a strong working relationship with Terry Smith, director of the Honors Program. While not officially required, I was asked by Terry to **review application essays** for the Honors Program and have provided feedback on approximately 50 essays, often returning detailed comments within 24 hours. Additionally, I assisted him with statistical analysis for a specific project, exploring potential methods to address his needs.

Beyond committee work, I have written over **25 letters of recommendation** for students, helping them secure graduate school placements, internships, and other professional opportunities. This has been a rewarding aspect of my role, as it allows me to directly support students' growth and future success.

Link to [Baseline Service Work Exhibit](#)

1.3.2 Service Achievements

Faculty members are expected to work toward and achieve a certain number of service achievements tied to each performance level. The annual self-evaluation and dossiers for tenure and promotion must reflect on and provide evidence for a faculty member's achievements. Service achievements can include but are not limited to:

- **Leadership on college committees**
 - Chair of Honors and Awards 2024 to present
 - Chair of IFRS FS22
- **Membership on ad hoc committees (such as search committees) or taskforces**
 - Highflex Committee
 - Inclusive Pedagogy Committee
 - Security Lead Interviewer
 - AI Specialist Search
 - Faculty search for Kurt Debord
 - Faculty search for Kruti Surti
- **Sharing expertise with other faculty members in a formal setting**
 - Learning Community AI
 - Introduction to AI in the classroom for Center for Teaching and Learning (CTL)
 - Teaching and Learning in an AI world for Center for Teaching and Learning (CTL)
 - Shared at Fall Faculty Conference
- **Contributions to interdisciplinary programs or team teaching**
 - Human Evolution, Neuroscience, Animal Behavior, Sensation-Perception, Statistics for Behavioral Sciences.
- **Representation of the department or college at activities, on- or off- campus**
 - Columbia STEM alliance mini course
 - Columbia College STEAM Summer Camp Co-Director
 - CC Faculty Focus video series
 - Participating in the campus community
- **Other evidence**
 - Faculty Mentor for Kruti Surti

Leadership on college committees

Chair of Academic Honors and Awards 2024 to present.

Chair of Instructional Facilities, Resources, and Support Committee 2022.

Membership on ad hoc committees (such as search committees) or taskforces

In the spring of 2021, I served on the Ad hoc **High Flex Committee**. The High Flex committee was commissioned by the provost and chaired by Peggy Wright. Our charge was to propose revisions to the High Flex model to bring it into alignment with the best interests of students and faculty. We surveyed faculty and drafted the current approach that allows for virtual attendance at the discretion of the course instructor, under certain circumstances.

Inclusive Pedagogy Committee (Fall 2023 – Present): I have served on the Inclusive Pedagogy Committee alongside Dean Jewell since its inception in Fall 2023. That summer, we held a retreat to establish the mission statement for the committee. Our initial task was creating materials to recruit faculty and staff to support our initiatives. In Spring 2024, we organized sub-committees, and I joined the Recruiting and Retention sub-committee to focus on bringing in and supporting diverse faculty and staff. I am currently on the Education sub-committee.

In the spring of 2023, I volunteered to serve as interviewer for the **Campus Safety Lead** position.

AI Specialist Search Committee chaired by Dean Moberly. Began over the summer of 2024. Our goal was to hire an AI expert to interface at many levels of the college, though the position was reassessed and then eliminated. However, subsequently in the fall semester, I was asked to be on a **taskforce** to move forward with ways to train faculty to use AI.

Faculty Search Committee for Dr. Kurt Debord 2023. Met for dinner in the evening with him. We used one of my class periods for his job talk and received feedback from students.

Faculty Search Committee for Kruti Surti 2024. Met for dinner in the evening and used one Neuroscience class period for her job talk, received written feedback from students. Recruited students to meet with Kruti for lunch. Conducted phone interviews. We had over 300 job applications for this position, it was a substantial lift.

Sharing expertise with other faculty members in a formal setting

I began working with **generative AI** in the spring of 2023. At first, it was simply a curiosity, but over the course of that semester and into the summer, it became a passion. I dedicated countless hours to honing my skills. By the Fall 2023, I had developed a significant level of expertise in generative AI and began sharing my knowledge with colleagues as mentioned with the Learning Community, CTL talks, FCC presentation, AI specialist search committee and subsequent taskforce. But also engaged in one-on-one discussions, such as with Dr. Mauxion.

Of particular interest in the Fall of 2023, after my summer of immersion, was incorporating AI into my Social Science Writing course. I was asked to present about my research and plans early in September for the CTL see [Introduction to AI in the classroom for CTL](#). Followed by a co-presentation at the end of the semester with Dr. Neilsen about my experiences see [Teaching and Learning in an AI world](#).

In Spring 2024, I **led a faculty learning community** through the CTL focused on helping colleagues explore and get started with AI. As an early adopter of AI technologies, I shared my knowledge and experiences with a group of faculty members. Over the course of five meetings throughout the semester, we experimented with and discussed foundational concepts, practical applications, and implications of AI in education. I maintained a running log of the topics and discussions covered during these sessions, which can be accessed [\[here\]](#). The plan is to have **another** learning community in the Spring 2025.

This initiative culminated in our group **presentation at the 2024 Fall Faculty Conference**, where we shared our insights and encouraged other faculty members to engage with AI in their teaching and assessment practices. A key takeaway for the group was recognizing the importance of understanding AI's capabilities in order to effectively evaluate student learning. Without this foundational knowledge, faculty risk being unable to differentiate between authentic student work and AI-generated content, underscoring the urgency for educators to stay informed in this rapidly evolving landscape.

[Contributions to interdisciplinary programs or team teaching](#)

While not formally a separate program, many of my classes are **cross-listed** with Biology, creating interdisciplinary connections that enrich both fields. Courses such as Human Evolution, Neuroscience, Animal Behavior, Sensation and Perception, and Statistics for the Behavioral Sciences (cross-listed as BIOL, PSYC, and SOCI) serve as platforms for students to explore the intersection of biological and psychological sciences. Beyond the curriculum, I strive to create an environment where biology and psychology seamlessly integrate, leveraging my expertise to highlight these connections in every class I teach. I believe that creates a deeper and more holistic understanding of both disciplines. I have had several students graduate with a minor in Biology.

[Representation of the department or college at activities, on- or off- campus](#)

In the Summer 2021 I joined with [Columbia STEM Alliance](#) to offer multiple class sessions to promote STEM interest in elementary and middle school students. My class was entitled “**Pretty Plants and Yucky Bugs?**” I worked closely with CC’s biology lab coordinator to obtain dissecting microscopes, and supplies. I co-taught with my wife, a current PhD student from MU, who brought her knowledge of entomology to share with the kids and served as an excellent role model for women in STEM. It was an interesting opportunity to expose middle and elementary school students to scientific concepts including ecological purposes of plants, flower anatomy, hands-on flower dissections and an introduction to entomology (the study of insects). Students got hands-on training in proper microscope use and looked at a variety of flowers and insects under magnification. The goal was to illustrate the importance of insect pollination, how flowers become fruits, and how these processes define our ecosystem. The entomology component is important, as too often students are not exposed to thinking about how beneficial insects are until they reach higher education (too late for them to appreciate and view insects in a positive way). Also, early exposure to microscopes and lab equipment is an awesome way to get young students interested in science. It was a great partnership between CC, MU and our local STEM alliance organization.

Building on my teaching experience, I **co-directed a STEAM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Art, and Mathematics) Summer Camp** with Ann Schlemper for students in grades 3–8. My wife and I managed the Science portion of the camp, utilizing the biology labs in Bruder Hall to create engaging, hands-on learning experiences. Over the course of the five-day camp, running from 7:30 AM to 5:30 PM daily, we

guided students through interactive projects such as exploring diffusion, UV light, surface tension, capillary action, insect vision, and microscopy. Dr. Russel even attended one of my sessions. This experience was meaningful for me, as it allowed me to translate my passion for science into impactful, hands-on education for young learners. In addition to teaching, I worked with local businesses to secure refreshments, supplies, materials, and the Witches and Wizards Arcade donate a couple of hours for campers to play any game for free. We organized daily events like the Missouri Department of Conservation bringing animals, a local beekeeper, Hickman's CASA Robotics (i.e., brought robotic dogs). I developed my ability to organize and execute a large-scale program. The link to service exhibits below has some photos and materials. Of particular interest is a clipping from MU's Biological Sciences Newsletter *The Buzz* highlighting our summer camp's association with MU through PhD candidate Darah Oxford, indicating our collaboration and extra press for CC.

In the fall of 2023, I was filmed for the **Faculty Video Series**. I believe that this serves as representing the College both on and off campus. See link [here](#).

Additionally, I make an effort to actively participate in campus events to be a positive part of our campus community, to foster a spirit of teamwork and support. Faculty had a great turn out at Storm the Gates this Fall 2024.



Lighting Ceremony December 2024

Other evidence

Fall of 2024 I served as **Faculty Mentor** for Kruti Surti.



Link to [Service Achievements Exhibits](#)